



**LOADED
DICE.®**

EMPLOYEE
HANDBOOK

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MISSION STATEMENT

At Loaded Dice, our mission is to inspire passion, spark nostalgia, and connect communities through unique hobbies and collectibles. We are dedicated to sourcing and curating exceptional items that bring joy to enthusiasts of all ages—whether you're discovering a new pastime, expanding a treasured collection, or reliving fond memories. With a commitment to authenticity, quality, and outstanding customer service, we aim to be the UK's trusted home for hobbyists and collectors, where every find tells a story and every collection grows with pride.

COMPANY VALUES

1. COMMUNITY FIRST

WE'RE MORE THAN JUST A SHOP - WE'RE A HUB WHERE FRIENDSHIPS ARE FORGED, RIVALRIES ARE PLAYFUL, AND EVERYONE FEELS WELCOME AT THE TABLE.

2. PLAY WITHOUT BARRIERS

HOBBIES AND GAMES ARE FOR EVERYONE. WE CHAMPION INCLUSIVITY, ACCESSIBILITY, AND DIVERSITY SO THAT ALL PLAYERS FEEL AT HOME, WHETHER THEY'RE ROLLING THEIR FIRST DICE OR PAINTING THEIR HUNDREDTH MINIATURE.

3. PASSION FOR PLAY

WE SHARE IN THE EXCITEMENT OF A WELL-PLAYED GAME, THE JOY OF COLLECTING, AND THE CREATIVITY OF HOBBY CRAFTSMANSHIP. OUR PASSION FUELS EVERYTHING WE DO.

4. KNOWLEDGE YOU CAN TRUST

FROM RULES CLARIFICATIONS TO HOBBY TIPS, WE PRIDE OURSELVES ON GIVING HONEST, RELIABLE ADVICE TO HELP YOU ENJOY YOUR GAMES TO THE FULLEST.

5. SUPPORTING LOCAL CREATIVITY

WE SHOWCASE AND SUPPORT LOCAL MAKERS, ARTISTS, AND INDIE GAME CREATORS, ENSURING OUR SHELVES REFLECT THE RICHNESS OF THE UK GAMING COMMUNITY.

6. SUSTAINABILITY MATTERS

WE AIM TO REDUCE WASTE, RECYCLE WHEREVER POSSIBLE, AND SUPPORT ECO-CONSCIOUS BRANDS SO FUTURE GENERATIONS CAN ENJOY THE WORLDS OF IMAGINATION WE LOVE.

7. FUN ABOVE ALL

AT THE HEART OF EVERY DICE ROLL, CARD DRAW, OR MODEL BUILD IS JOY. WE EXIST TO CELEBRATE THAT FUN, WHETHER IN-STORE, ONLINE, OR AT THE GAMING TABLE.

COMPANY CULTURE

At Loaded Dice, our culture is built around play, community, and creativity. We believe games and hobbies bring people together, spark imagination, and create lasting friendships.

We foster a welcoming, inclusive space where everyone - from curious beginners to seasoned hobbyists - feels at home. Our team leads with passion, sharing knowledge freely and celebrating the joy of discovery.

We're committed to supporting the local gaming and creative community, championing independent makers and providing a space where stories, skills, and strategies can be shared.

Sustainability matters to us, and we strive to make mindful choices that keep our hobby worlds thriving for the future. Above all, we embrace the spirit of fun: whether it's rolling dice, painting miniatures, or learning a new game, we believe every moment should be filled with excitement and connection.

THE RIGHTS AND OBLIGATIONS OF THE EMPLOYEE

RESPECT & INCLUSION

EVERY EMPLOYEE HAS THE RIGHT TO A SAFE, WELCOMING, AND INCLUSIVE WORKPLACE WHERE INDIVIDUALITY IS VALUED, AND DISCRIMINATION OR HARASSMENT HAS NO PLACE.

FAIR PAY & SECURITY

EMPLOYEES HAVE THE RIGHT TO FAIR WAGES IN LINE WITH UK LAW, TRANSPARENT CONTRACTS, AND RELIABLE SCHEDULING THAT RESPECTS THEIR TIME AND COMMITMENTS.

GROWTH & DEVELOPMENT

EVERYONE HAS THE RIGHT TO TRAINING, FEEDBACK, AND OPPORTUNITIES TO GROW THEIR SKILLS - WHETHER IN CUSTOMER SERVICE, GAMING KNOWLEDGE, OR CREATIVE HOBBIES.

WORK-LIFE BALANCE

ALL EMPLOYEES HAVE THE RIGHT TO REST, BREAKS, AND TIME AWAY FROM WORK, ENSURING A HEALTHY BALANCE BETWEEN THEIR PASSION FOR GAMES AND THEIR PERSONAL WELLBEING.

WHAT WE **EXPECT** FROM YOU



POSITIVITY AND RESPECT

Treat every customer and teammate with kindness, patience, and inclusivity - helping us make the shop a welcoming space for all.



SHARE YOUR PASSION

Use your enthusiasm for games and hobbies to inspire others, offer helpful advice, and contribute to a fun, knowledgeable environment.



TAKE PRIDE IN YOUR WORK

Be reliable, professional, and attentive - whether running events, keeping the store organised, or supporting fellow staff.



Equal Opportunities and Diversity Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 22 Sept 2025

1. Policy Statement Loaded Dice is committed to creating and maintaining a working environment that promotes equality of opportunity, values diversity, and is free from discrimination, harassment, and victimisation.

We embrace the principles set out in the **Equality Act 2010**, ensuring that no employee, job applicant, client, or customer is treated less favourably on the basis of any **protected characteristic**, including:

- Age
- Disability
- Gender reassignment
- Marriage and civil partnership
- Pregnancy and maternity
- Race (including colour, nationality, and ethnic or national origin)
- Religion or belief
- Sex
- Sexual orientation

We are committed to removing barriers to participation, challenging unfair practices, and fostering a culture of dignity and respect for all.

All personal data processed in connection with this Policy will be handled in line with the Company's Data Protection Policy.

2. Objectives

The objectives of this Policy are to:

- Prevent and eliminate all forms of unlawful discrimination, harassment, and victimisation.
- Ensure equality of opportunity in recruitment, training, promotion, pay, benefits, and career development.
- Support an inclusive workplace culture in which individual differences are respected and valued.
- Provide services and goods to clients and customers in a way that is inclusive and free from discrimination.

3. Designated Officer

Loaded Dice employ a Designated Officer to oversee compliance with this Policy and to act as the first point of contact for concerns.

Currently: Assistant Managing Director. Contact details are available internally.

4. Definitions

Discrimination is unequal treatment based on a protected characteristic, resulting in a person being treated more or less favourably than others in comparable circumstances. It may be:

- **Direct discrimination** – where someone is treated less favourably because of a protected characteristic.
- **Indirect discrimination** – where a provision, criterion, or practice applies to everyone but disproportionately disadvantages people with a protected characteristic, and cannot be objectively justified. **Harassment** – unwanted conduct related to a protected characteristic that violates a person's dignity or creates an intimidating, hostile, degrading, humiliating, or offensive environment.
- **Victimisation** – treating someone less favourably because they have raised or supported a complaint of discrimination.

5. Positive Action

Under Section 159 of the Equality Act 2010, the Company may take steps to encourage applications from underrepresented groups.

In recruitment or promotion, positive action will only be applied in a tie-break situation, where candidates are equally qualified.

6. Reasonable Adjustments The Company has a duty to make reasonable adjustments to remove barriers faced by employees or applicants with disabilities. These may include (but are not limited to):

- Adjustments to premises or equipment
- Re-allocation of duties
- Flexible working arrangements
- Provision of training, mentoring, or adapted materials
- Paid time off for treatment or rehabilitation

Adjustments will be agreed in consultation with the individual concerned and implemented where reasonable and practicable.

7. Responsibilities

- All employees, contractors, and agents must avoid discriminatory behaviour and treat others with dignity and respect.
- Managers and senior leaders are responsible for promoting this Policy, ensuring fair decision-making, and addressing concerns promptly.
- Loaded Dice accepts ultimate responsibility for achieving the objectives of this Policy and ensuring compliance with equality law.

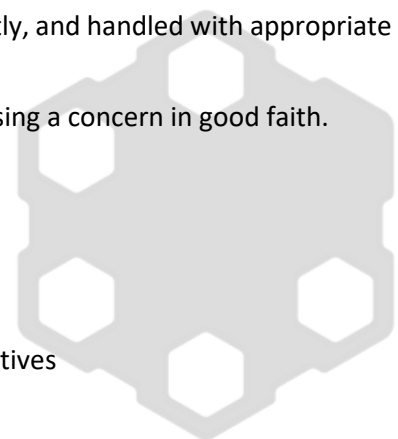
Employees may be held individually liable for discriminatory acts. In some cases, an Employment Tribunal may also order them to pay compensation.

8. Reporting and Acting on Concerns Any employee who experiences, witnesses, or suspects discrimination, harassment, or victimisation should report it to the Designated Officer as soon as possible.

- All concerns will be treated seriously, investigated promptly, and handled with appropriate confidentiality.
- No employee will suffer retaliation or victimisation for raising a concern in good faith.

9. Advice and Support Employees can seek advice or support from:

- **Internal support:** HR or employee/trade union representatives
- **External organisations:**
 - **Equality and Human Rights Commission** – www.equalityhumanrights.com **ACAS**
 - **(Advisory, Conciliation and Arbitration Service)** – Helpline: 0300 123 1100 | www.acas.org.uk



- o Citizens Advice Bureau – www.citizensadvice.org.uk Civil Legal Advice (for free legal
- o aid advice) – 0345 345 4 345 | [www.gov.uk/civil-legal-](http://www.gov.uk/civil-legal-advice)
advice

10. Monitoring, Review, and Extent of the Policy

- This Policy applies to all aspects of employment, including recruitment, training, performance management, promotion, pay, benefits, redundancy, and dismissal. It also applies to the provision of goods and services. The Policy does not form part of an employee's contract of
- employment. Loaded Dice reserves the right to amend this Policy when necessary. This Policy
- will be reviewed annually to ensure it remains up to date, relevant, and effective.
-

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt

Position: Managing Director

Date: 23/9/25

Signature: *Graham Scutt*





Harassment and Bullying Policy

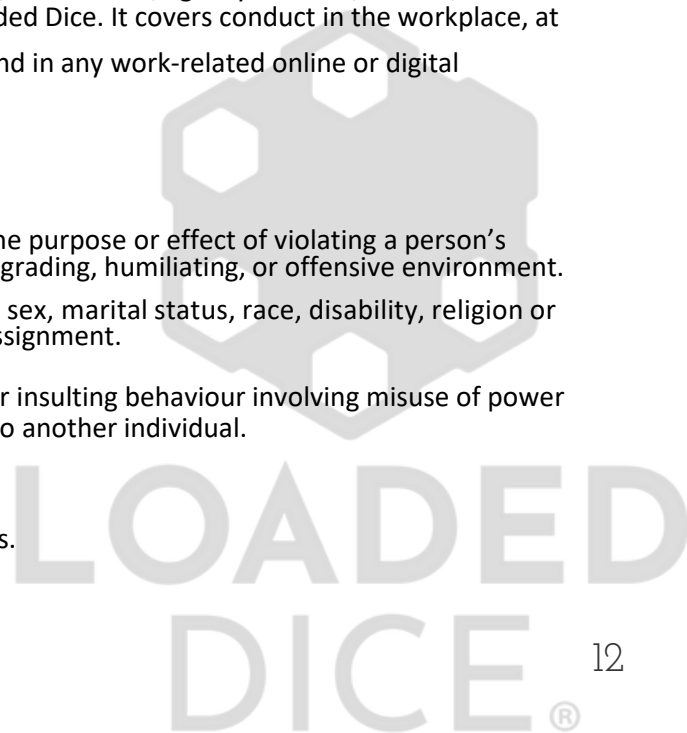
Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 22 Sept 2025

1. Policy Statement

- 1.1 Loaded Dice is committed to providing a safe, supportive, and stimulating working environment in which all staff can achieve their potential. Such an environment cannot exist where any individual is subjected to harassment, bullying, intimidation, coercion, or other inappropriate conduct.
- 1.2 The organisation is fully committed to the principles of equality, diversity, and inclusion. Harassment and bullying are recognised as forms of discrimination and will not be tolerated under any circumstances.
- 1.3 All complaints of harassment or bullying will be treated seriously, investigated promptly, and handled with sensitivity and confidentiality.
- 1.4 This Policy applies to all employees, managers, contractors, agency workers, interns, consultants, and third parties engaged by Loaded Dice. It covers conduct in the workplace, at work-related events, during business travel, and in any work-related online or digital communications.

2. Definitions of Harassment and Bullying

- 2.1 Harassment is unwanted conduct which has the purpose or effect of violating a person's dignity, or creating an intimidating, hostile, degrading, humiliating, or offensive environment. It may relate (but is not limited) to a person's sex, marital status, race, disability, religion or beliefs, sexual orientation, age, or gender reassignment.
- 2.2 Bullying is offensive, intimidating, malicious, or insulting behaviour involving misuse of power that undermines, humiliates, or causes harm to another individual.
- 2.3 Harassment and bullying may:
 - Be persistent or occur as isolated incidents.



- Be obvious or subtle. Occur face-to-face, in writing, electronically (including emails, texts, and social media), or indirectly.
- Arise from unequal or unfair application of rules or monitoring.

2.4 Examples include (but are not limited to):

- Spreading malicious rumours or gossip. Deliberate exclusion from professional or social activities. Verbal abuse, insults, threats, or offensive jokes.
- Unwelcome sexual advances, comments, or physical contact. Threats relating to job security. Undermining competence through unreasonable workload or unfair criticism. Overbearing supervision or excessive monitoring. Circulation of offensive materials, graffiti, or images. Online or digital harassment (including social media). Inciting others to engage in such behaviour.
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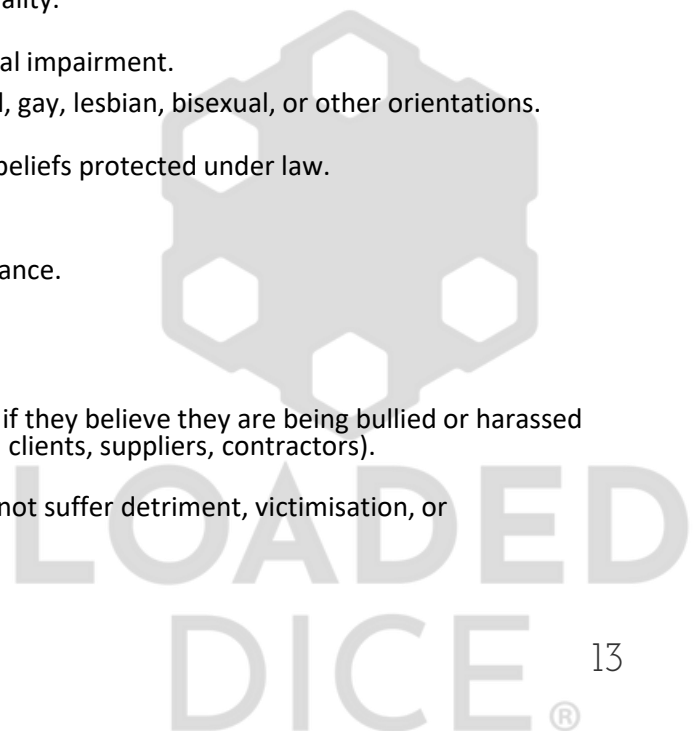
3. Unlawful Grounds of Harassment or Bullying

Loaded Dice will not tolerate harassment or bullying on any grounds. The following are expressly unlawful and prohibited under the Equality Act 2010 and other relevant legislation:

- Sex: harassment or bullying based on sex, pregnancy, or maternity.
- Marital or Civil Partnership Status.
- Gender Reassignment: harassment due to an individual's intent to undergo, undergoing, or having undergone gender reassignment.
- Sexual Harassment: unwanted physical, verbal, or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature.
- Race: including colour, ethnicity, or nationality.
- Disability: relating to any physical or mental impairment.
- Sexual Orientation: including heterosexual, gay, lesbian, bisexual, or other orientations.
- Religion or Belief: including philosophical beliefs protected under law.
- Age: applicable to all ages.
- Grievance: victimisation for raising a grievance.

4. Reporting Harassment or Bullying

- 4.1 Employees have the right to raise a complaint if they believe they are being bullied or harassed by colleagues, managers, or third parties (e.g., clients, suppliers, contractors).
- 4.2 Employees who raise genuine complaints will not suffer detriment, victimisation, or retaliation.



4.3 Complaints may be raised informally or formally, depending on the circumstances.

5. Procedure for Complaints

5.1 Complaints should be raised as soon as reasonably practicable. Employees may report concerns to their line manager, the Assistant Managing Director, the Managing Director, or Human Resources. Where the complaint involves one of these individuals, an alternative reporting route will be provided.

5.3 Informal Procedure

- Employees are encouraged, where appropriate, to address the behaviour directly with the individual concerned, making clear that it is unwanted and must stop.
- Alternatively, employees may seek support from a manager, colleague, or HR representative to address the matter informally.
- Employees may also submit their concerns in writing, keeping copies of correspondence and maintaining an incident diary.
- If informal resolution is unsuccessful or inappropriate, a formal complaint may be submitted.

5.4 Formal Procedure

5.4.1 A formal complaint should be raised under the Loaded Dice Grievance Procedure. It should include:

- The name of the person whose behaviour is alleged to be harassment or bullying.
- Details of the behaviour, including specific examples, dates, and times.
- Names of any witnesses.
- Steps already taken to address the matter.

5.4.2 Complaints will normally be acknowledged within five working days and investigated within 20 working days, subject to complexity.

5.4.3 The person accused will be informed of the complaint and given an opportunity to respond.

6. Consequences of Breach

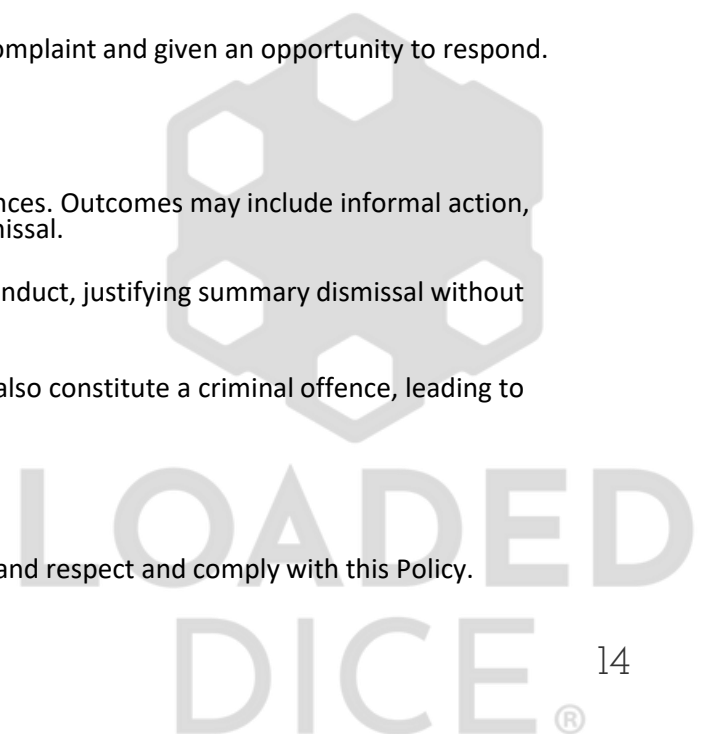
6.1 Harassment and bullying are disciplinary offences. Outcomes may include informal action, mandatory training, written warnings, or dismissal.

6.2 Serious incidents may amount to gross misconduct, justifying summary dismissal without notice.

6.3 Certain forms of harassment or bullying may also constitute a criminal offence, leading to prosecution, fines, or imprisonment.

7. Responsibilities of Employees and Managers

- All employees must treat others with dignity and respect and comply with this Policy.



- Managers must promote a culture of respect, ensure staff are aware of the Policy, and intervene promptly when unacceptable behaviour is observed or reported.
- Any complaints received must be handled fairly, consistently, and confidentially.
- All incidents will be reported to the Assistant Managing Director and HR.

8. Support and Advice

- Loaded Dice will offer counselling, mediation, or other appropriate support. Employees may
- also seek confidential advice from HR, trade union representatives, or external advisory services such as ACAS.

9. Confidentiality

- 9.1 All complaints will be handled with strict confidentiality, consistent with a fair investigation process.
- 9.2 Employees involved in an investigation must respect confidentiality at all times.
- 9.3 Records of complaints and investigations will be kept securely and processed in accordance with the UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018.
- 9.4 Confidentiality may be overridden where disclosure is legally required (e.g., safeguarding or criminal activity).
- 9.5 Breaches of confidentiality may result in disciplinary action.

This Policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt
 Position: Managing Director
 Date: 23/9/25
 Signature:

Graham Scutt



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Health and Safety Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 25 Sept 2025

1. Introduction Loaded Dice actively promotes a Safe working environment for its employees and visitors/Customers, working with continuous improvement Loaded Dice Seeks to have the safest workspaces, while promoting Health, Safety and Environmental initiatives with a dedicated workforce engaged at all levels.

2. Policy statement

Part 1: Statement of intent

This is the health and safety policy statement of:

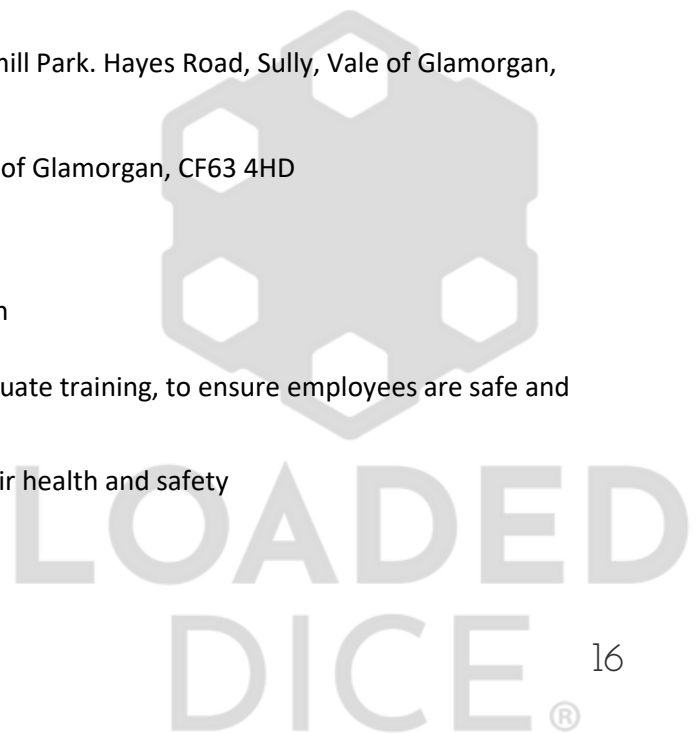
LOADED DICE
Mr Graham Scutt, Managing Director

Warehouse/Head Office: Loaded Dice, Unit 4C, Windmill Park. Hayes Road, Sully, Vale of Glamorgan, CF64 5AD

Retail Shop: Loaded Dice, 28 Holton Road, Barry, Vale of Glamorgan, CF63 4HD

Our health and safety policy is to:

- prevent accidents and cases of work-related ill health
- manage health and safety risks in our workplace
- provide clear instructions and information, and adequate training, to ensure employees are safe and competent to do their work
- provide personal protective equipment
- consult with our employees on matters affecting their health and safety
- provide and maintain safe plant and equipment
- ensure safe handling and use of substances



-maintain safe and healthy working conditions -implement emergency procedures, including evacuation in case of fire or significant incident -review and revise this policy regularly

Part2: Responsibilities for health and safety

1.Overall and final responsibility for health and safety:

MrGraham Scutt
Managing Director

2. Day-to-day responsibilities for ensuring this policy is put into practice:

Mr Christopher Scutt

3. To ensure health and safety standards are maintained/improved, the following people have responsibility in the following areas:

Mr Christopher Scutt: Warehouse and Shop
Mr Ben Roberts-Shop

4 All employees should, in line with the Health & Safety at work act 1974:

- co-operate with supervisors and managers on health and safety matters.
- Use and take care of PPE as directed by management and Risk assessment
- take reasonable care of their own health and safety; and
- report all health and safety concerns to an appropriate person.

Part 3: Arrangements for health and safety

- Risk assessment
- LD001: Loaded Dice Shop Risk assessment
- LD002: Loaded Dice Warehouse Risk Assessment
- COSHH Assessment
- LDCOSHH001Loaded Dice COSHH assessment
- Training
- SAGE/Safety Training
- Evacuation
- Loaded Dice Fire emergency procedures in LD001-2

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt
Position: Managing Director
Date: 23/9/25
Signature:

Graham Scutt



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GDPR Employee Data Protection Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 22 Sept 2025

1. Introduction

Loaded Dice is committed to protecting the privacy and rights of its employees in accordance with the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR), the EU GDPR (where applicable), the Data Protection Act 2018, and all relevant laws.

This policy explains how we process personal data of employees, workers, contractors, and other individuals engaged by the Company. It applies to both automated and manual records and covers all stages of the employment relationship.

2. Data Protection Principles

Loaded Dice will comply with the following GDPR principles when processing personal data:

1. Process data lawfully, fairly, and transparently.
2. Collect data only for specified, explicit, and legitimate purposes.
3. Limit data to what is necessary for those purposes.
4. Keep data accurate and up to date.
5. Retain data only as long as necessary.
6. Protect data with appropriate security measures.
7. Be able to demonstrate compliance ("accountability").

3. Employee Rights

Employees (as "data subjects") have the following rights:

- To be informed about the collection and use of their personal data.
- To access their data.
- To request correction of inaccurate or incomplete data.



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To request deletion in certain circumstances. To restrict or object to processing in certain circumstances. To request portability of their data. To not be subject to solely automated decisions that have legal or significant effects.

Employees can exercise these rights by contacting the Data Protection Officer (DPO) or Data Protection Lead.

4. Lawful, Fair, and Transparent Processing

Loaded Dice processes personal data only where a lawful basis applies. For most HR data this will be:

- Contractual necessity (e.g., payroll, benefits).
- Legal obligations (e.g., tax, health & safety).
- Legitimate interests (e.g., business operations, workforce planning).
- Consent (only where freely given and not a condition of employment).

Special category data (e.g., health, ethnicity) will only be processed under strict conditions permitted by law.

5. Data Accuracy

Employees must ensure Loaded Dice holds accurate and up-to-date information. Personal details should be updated promptly via [HR system/HR contact]. Loaded Dice will review employee data at least annually to maintain accuracy.

6. Data Retention

Personal data will only be kept for as long as necessary for employment, legal, or business purposes. Typical retention periods include:

- Payroll/tax records – 7 years.
- Recruitment data – 6 months (unless extended with consent).
- Disciplinary records – 2 years.
- Health and safety records – as legally required.

A full retention schedule is available in Loaded Dice Records Retention Policy.

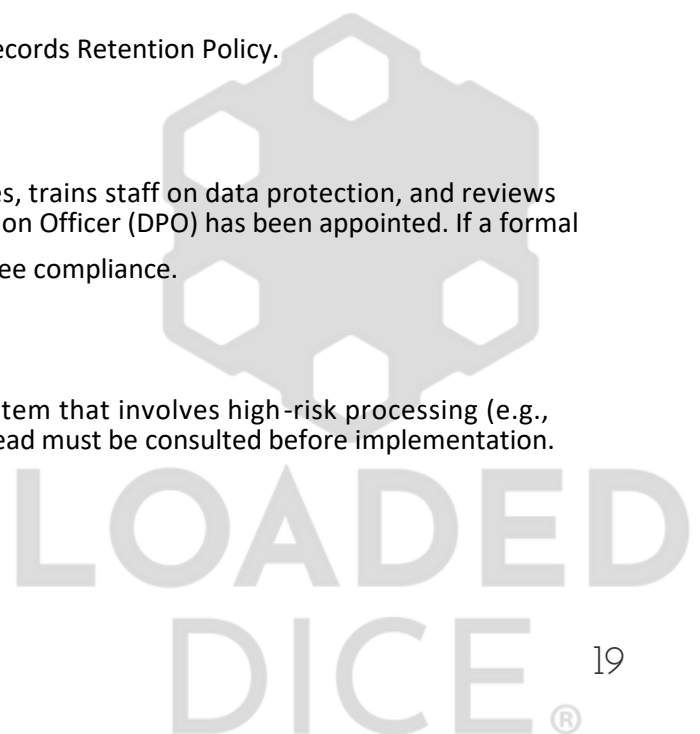
7. Accountability and Governance

Loaded Dice maintains records of processing activities, trains staff on data protection, and reviews compliance regularly. Where required, a Data Protection Officer (DPO) has been appointed. If a formal DPO is not required, a Data Protection Lead will oversee compliance.

8. Data Protection Impact Assessments (DPIAs)

ADPIA will be carried out for any new project or system that involves high-risk processing (e.g., monitoring tools, large-scale health data). The DPO/Lead must be consulted before implementation.

9. Information for Employees



Loaded Dice provides employees with a clear Privacy Notice that sets out:

- What data is collected.
- Why it is processed.
- The legal basis for processing.
- How long it is retained.
- Who it is shared with.
- Contact details of the DPO/Lead.

10. Categories of Data Processed

Loaded Dice processes the following types of employee data:

- Personal identification: name, date of birth, address, contact details, NI number.
- Employment details: job title, terms of employment, attendance, performance records.
- Payroll and financial data: salary, bank details, tax information.
- Special category data: health information, equal opportunities monitoring data (anonymised where possible).
- Disciplinary and grievance records.
- Training and development records.

11. Data Security

Technical Measures

- Secure servers, firewalls, and encryption (AES-256 or equivalent).
- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) for remote access and critical systems.
- Regular security patching and monitoring.
- Encrypted backups stored securely and tested monthly.

Organisational Measures

- Access to employee data is limited to staff who need it for legitimate business purposes.
- All staff receive data protection training during onboarding and annual refreshers.
- Physical records are stored securely and disposed of via shredding/confidential waste.
- Remote working must comply with IT security standards (e.g., VPN, company-approved devices).

12. International Transfers

Where personal data is transferred outside the UK/EU, Loaded Dice will ensure appropriate safeguards, such as:

- Adequacy decisions (e.g., UK/EU recognised countries).
- Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs).
- EU–US Data Privacy Framework (if applicable).

13. Data Breach Notification

Employees must immediately report any suspected personal data breach (e.g., lost devices, mis-sent emails) to the DPO/IT.



Loaded Dice will:

- Assess and contain the breach.
- Notify the ICO within 72 hours if legally required.
- Inform affected employees where there is a high risk to their rights and freedoms.

14. Implementation and Review

This policy is effective from 22 Sep 2025 and applies to all employees, contractors, and third parties handling employee data. It will be reviewed annually, or sooner if required by changes in law or business practices.

Contact: Leigh O'Dell
Assistant Managing Director
Data Protection Officer

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt
Position: Managing Director
Date: 23/9/25
Signature:

Graham Scutt



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Communications, Email, Internet and Social Media Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 22 Sept 2025

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy applies to all employees of Loaded Dice who use Company communication tools, computers, mobile devices, or systems (Facilities).

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Support effective business communication.
- Protect the Company's reputation and legal compliance.
- Provide clear guidance on acceptable and unacceptable use of Company Facilities.

Limited personal use of Facilities is permitted where it does not interfere with work duties, breach this policy, or damage the Company's interests.

This policy should be read alongside Loaded Dice other policies, including the Data Protection Policy, Equal Opportunities and Diversity Policy, and Harassment and Bullying Policy.

2. General Principles

Employees must always use Facilities responsibly, professionally, and in line with their contractual duties. In particular, employees must:

- Protect confidential, restricted, or sensitive information and only share it with proper authority.
- Handle personal data in line with Loaded Dice Data Protection Policy.
- Respect copyright, intellectual property, and applicable laws.
- Avoid committing Loaded Dice to agreements without authorisation.

- Remember that communications may be relied upon in legal or regulatory proceedings.

Prohibited Use (Gross Misconduct):

Employees must never view, transmit, download, or access:

- Offensive, pornographic, discriminatory, or harassing material.
- Illegal or criminal material, including pirated software or content.
- Confidential information they are not authorised to access.
- Websites or services that the Company has blocked.

3. Internet Use

- Internet access is provided primarily for business use. Limited personal use is permitted if reasonable and not disruptive.
 - Employees must not attempt unauthorised access to systems, databases, or restricted areas.
 - The introduction of malware, spyware, or any malicious code is strictly prohibited.
 - No unauthorised software may be downloaded or installed.
- Content that is illegal, offensive, or likely to damage Loaded Dice reputation must not be accessed.
Requests for access to blocked sites must be approved by the Managing Director.

4. Social Media Use

4.1 General Rules Social Media includes, but is not limited to, LinkedIn, X (Twitter), Facebook,

Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube.

When using Social Media, whether for personal or business purposes, employees must:

- Act responsibly and professionally.
- Protect confidential information, proprietary data, and personal data.
- Respect intellectual property rights.
- Avoid content that could harm Loaded Dice reputation or breach other Loaded Dice policies.
- Understand that online communications may be used in legal or regulatory proceedings.

If in doubt, employees should seek guidance from the Assistant Managing Director before posting.

4.2 Personal Use

- Personal use of Social Media during work should be limited to breaks and must not affect productivity. Employees must not give the impression they are speaking on behalf of Loaded Dice unless authorised. Where Loaded Dice is mentioned, employees should make clear that opinions expressed are their own. Loaded Dice email addresses must not be used to register for personal Social Media accounts.

4.3 Business Use



- Only employees authorised by the Managing Director may use Social Media on behalf of Loaded Dice. Business-related interactions must be accurate, respectful, and aligned with Loaded Dice messaging. Social Media contacts made in the course of business are Loaded Dice property. Training may be required before employees manage official Loaded Dice accounts.

4.4 Unacceptable Use

Employees must not post or share:

- Defamatory, misleading, discriminatory, or harassing content.
- Confidential or commercially sensitive information.
- Personal data of colleagues, customers, or other third parties without authority.
- Company trademarks, logos, or branding without approval.

5. Email Use

5.1 Business Email

- All business communications must be conducted via Loaded Dice email (@loadeddice.uk).
- Emails must be professional, accurate, and respectful.
- Confidential information must not be shared without authority.
- Emails may be disclosed in court or regulatory proceedings.
- Best practice includes proofreading, checking attachments, and ensuring disclaimers are included.

5.2 Personal Email

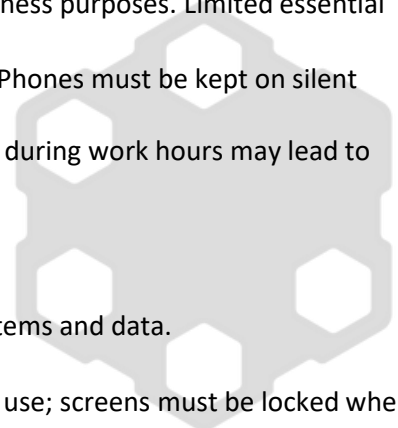
- Personal email accounts may be accessed only occasionally and where it does not interfere with work.
- Loaded Dice email must not be used for personal purposes.

6. Telephone and Mobile Use

- Loaded Dice telephones and mobiles are provided for business purposes. Limited essential personal calls are acceptable but must not be excessive.
- Employees' personal mobile use should not disrupt work. Phones must be kept on silent during working hours.
- Excessive personal use of Loaded Dice or personal devices during work hours may lead to disciplinary action.

7. Security

- Employees are responsible for protecting Loaded Dice systems and data.
- Passwords must be kept secure and changed regularly.
- Confidential documents must be locked away when not in use; screens must be locked when unattended.
- Loaded Dice devices must be secured, especially when travelling.
- Public Wi-Fi should only be used if secure and Company-approved.
- No unauthorised equipment may be connected to Loaded Dice systems.



8. Monitoring

- Loaded Dice may monitor use of Facilities, in line with applicable law, for legitimate business purposes including security, service quality, compliance, and prevention of misuse.
- Internet traffic and email logs are retained. Personal use may therefore be visible.
- Employees should avoid visiting sites or sending emails that could reveal sensitive personal information (e.g., political or religious beliefs).
Monitoring will be proportionate and in line with GDPR and other legal requirements.

9. Recruitment

As part of recruitment, Loaded Dice may review publicly available online information. Any searches will comply with data protection and equal opportunities obligations.

10. Misuse and Compliance

- Misuse of Loaded Dice Facilities will be dealt with under the Loaded Dice Disciplinary Policy and may, in serious cases, constitute gross misconduct or a criminal offence.
 - Loaded Dice may investigate misuse and, where criminal activity is suspected, report matters to the police.
- Employees who are uncertain whether an action is acceptable should seek guidance before proceeding.

11. Policy Compliance

By using Loaded Dice Facilities, employees agree to comply with this policy. Breaches may result in disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

This Policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt

Position: Managing Director

Date: 23/9/25

Signature: *Graham Scutt*



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Disciplinary Policy and Procedure

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 22 Sept 2025

1. Introduction

Loaded Dice requires exemplary standards of discipline from its employees, together with satisfactory standards of work. The purpose of the disciplinary procedure is to ensure that any concerns over employees' conduct or performance are handled in a fair, consistent and timely manner, with the intention of bringing about an improvement, and to protect the proper operation of Loaded Dice business and the health and safety of its employees. This procedure may be reviewed and updated from time to time. Any amendments will be notified to employees in writing, following consultation and/or notice where appropriate.

Where time limits are specified in this Policy and Procedure, they may be varied by agreement between the Company and the employee.

During the probationary period, the full disciplinary and grievance procedure will not apply.

The Disciplinary Policy and Procedure do not form part of the contract of employment.

2. Rules and Application

2.1 The following are examples of conduct/performance that will normally be addressed through implementation of the Loaded Dice disciplinary procedure:

- 2.1.1 Unsatisfactory work performance;
- 2.1.2 Breaches of Company policies and procedures;
- 2.1.3 Inappropriate behaviour (e.g. fighting, drunkenness, etc.);
- 2.1.4 Bullying, harassment or victimisation;

- 2.1.5 Discrimination on any of the grounds listed in the Company's [***Equality and Diversity/Equal Opportunity Policy***: e.g. race, sex, sexual orientation, religion, disability, age, gender reassignment, marital status or ethnic origin];
- 2.1.6 Persistent lateness or poor timekeeping;
- 2.1.7 Unacceptable levels of absence, especially when unauthorised;
- 2.1.8 Serious or repeated failure to follow reasonable requests or instructions;
- 2.1.9 Abuse, misuse or neglect of Company property or facilities;
- 2.1.10 Bribery offences under the Bribery Act 2010; and
- 2.1.11 Use of Company facilities and equipment for personal reasons during work time e.g. Company email, telephones and internet access.

2.2 Confidentiality:

- 2.2.1 Disciplinary matters will be handled with as high a degree of confidentiality as is practicable, particularly when the issue is of a sensitive nature.
- 2.2.2 Confidential records of disciplinary matters will be kept in the employee's personnel file in accordance with Data Protection legislation. Copies of meeting notes will be provided to the employee, although Loaded Dice reserves the right to withhold certain information (e.g. to protect a witness).
- 2.2.3 Employees and witnesses are expected to maintain confidentiality regarding disciplinary matters.

2.3 Investigation:

- 2.3.1 The employee's line manager will promptly and thoroughly investigate any matter that is reasonably believed to be a disciplinary matter. The employee concerned will be informed of the investigation as soon as possible and when it has been concluded. Employees will be told who is conducting the investigation and can provide their own evidence/witnesses.
- 2.3.2 The employee may be asked to attend an investigatory interview. If such an interview is held prior to a disciplinary meeting, the employee will be advised from the start that the interview is an investigatory interview. Employees will have the right to be accompanied at formal investigation meetings if potential disciplinary action may follow.
- 2.3.3 Loaded Dice reserves the right to omit the investigatory interview stage and move straight to a formal disciplinary meeting.

2.4 Suspension:

- 2.4.1 Loaded Dice reserves the right to suspend an employee from work, normally for no more than 5 working days, while a disciplinary offence is being investigated.
- 2.4.2 Employees will be advised if the suspension is likely to last longer than 5 working days.

- 2.4.3 Suspension is not regarded by Loaded Dice as disciplinary action. Loaded Dice shall inform the employee of the reason for the suspension. Suspension is a neutral act and not disciplinary action.
- 2.4.4 Employees may be suspended without pay or on reduced pay but only if this is allowed by their employment contract and Loaded Dice is acting reasonably.
- 2.5 Loaded Dice reserves the right to:
- 2.5.1 monitor employees' activities including telephone calls, email messages and internet use at any time, whether as part of a disciplinary investigation or otherwise.
Employees should therefore not consider such activities and methods of communication to be confidential when conducted at work.
- 2.5.2 Search an employee's desk, bags, pockets, vehicle or other Loaded Dice property or personal possessions where such action is considered necessary in the opinion of Loaded Dice. A search will only be carried out by an appropriate person in the presence of a witness and employees may request the presence of a work colleague.

3. **Disciplinary Procedure**

3.1 ***Informal Discussion***

- 3.1.1 Loaded Dice will initially try to resolve disciplinary issues informally by way of an informal discussion with the employee concerned.
- 3.1.2 This is a two-way discussion where Loaded Dice will be able to inform the employee of their shortcomings in conduct or performance and at the same time provide the employee with the opportunity to provide an explanation. The main purpose of the informal talk is to find a solution to the problem that is beneficial for both Loaded Dice and the employee.
- 3.1.3 Generally, cases of minor misconduct and/or unsatisfactory performance are dealt with informally. In the event of poor performance, disciplinary meetings will usually only be undertaken where counselling the employee and further training (if required) has failed to produce a satisfactory improvement to performance.
- However, if the informal action does not provide a solution to the problem or if the disciplinary issue is too serious to be dealt with informally, then the formal disciplinary procedure will be followed.

3.2 ***Written Notice of Intended Disciplinary Meeting***

- 3.2.1 If it is decided that there is a disciplinary case to answer, Loaded Dice will write to the employee, giving them a minimum of 3 days' notice of the meeting and advising the employee of their right to be accompanied to the meeting. This is a statutory right under the Employment Relations Act 1999.
- 3.2.2 At the same time, Loaded Dice will provide the employee with written notice informing them that this constitutes the start of the formal disciplinary procedure and as such outline:
- the alleged misconduct or poor performance and any possible consequences of these;

- the improvement that is required, any timescale for achieving this improvement and any support available (if appropriate);
 - details as to the time and venue of the disciplinary meeting; and
 - notice of the employee's statutory right to be accompanied if the meeting could result in a formal warning, the confirmation of a warning or the taking of some other disciplinary action. (This statutory right can be exercised once the employee has made a reasonable request to be accompanied).
- 3.2.3 The employee's chosen companion will be able to address the meeting to put or sum up the employee's case as well as confer with the employee during the meeting.
- They may not, however, answer questions on the employee's behalf, address the meeting if the employee does not wish them to do so or prevent Loaded Dice from explaining their case. The companion can be a fellow employee, trade union representative or official employed by a trade union.
- 3.2.4 The meeting will be scheduled in order to give the employee reasonable time to prepare for the meeting.
- 3.2.5 Loaded Dice will establish the facts before the meeting by collecting documents, identifying any relevant people to interview and taking statements before memories start to fade. Any requests for anonymity and confidentiality should be taken seriously. At least 3 days before the meeting, the employee should be provided with all relevant information, including statements, upon which Loaded Dice intends to rely.
- 3.2.6 Where Loaded Dice or an employee intends to call relevant witnesses, they should give advance notice to the other party that they intend to do this. It may also be appropriate to provide copies of written evidence including any witness statements. If
- 3.2.7 the employee is unable to attend the disciplinary meeting at the agreed time, Loaded Dice shall offer an alternative reasonable time and date. Loaded Dice shall give at least 3 days' notice of any rearranged meeting. If the employee fails to attend the rearranged meeting, Loaded Dice, taking into consideration any reasons and concluding that such failure is without good cause, is free to decide upon the matter using the evidence available. In these circumstances, the employee will be allowed to make written submissions.

3.3 ***Disciplinary meeting***

- 3.3.1 A disciplinary meeting will normally be conducted by the employee's line manager.
- 3.3.2 Loaded Dice will explain the complaint against the employee and go through any relevant evidence.
- 3.3.3 The employee will then be given the opportunity to present their own evidence, answer any allegations, ask questions and call relevant witnesses.
- 3.3.4 If Loaded Dice is unable to attend the meeting, such a delay should be conveyed to the employee at the earliest opportunity and a reasonable alternative should be provided to the employee.

3.3.5 Where possible, a manager who did not carry out the investigation will attend the meeting.

3.4 **Outcome of meeting**

3.4.1 As soon as possible after the conclusion of the disciplinary meeting, the employee's line manager will inform the employee what disciplinary action, if any, will be taken. If Loaded Dice finds there has been no misconduct/ poor performance, the employee will be informed of this in writing.

3.4.2 Where a minor offence has been committed, a recorded verbal warning may be given. The warning will state that any further misconduct will render the employee liable to further, more severe, disciplinary action. The employee shall be informed the verbal warning will remain 'live' for 6 months.

3.4.3 *First Written Warning* - If more serious misconduct/poor performance or further minor offences are confirmed, Loaded Dice will issue a written warning setting out the complaint and stating that further misconduct or a failure to improve performance may result in further disciplinary action. This letter will include details as to the improvement required, time-scales for such improvement and details of any help that will be made available for example, further training. The employee shall be informed the first written warning will be 'live' for 12 months and advised of their right to appeal against the warning.

3.4.4 *Final Written Warning* - If the misconduct/ poor performance is sufficiently serious or there has been further misconduct or a failure to improve since a previous written warning, Loaded Dice may issue a final written warning. This will give details of the complaint and nature of the misconduct/poor performance, the improvement required, the time-scale for such improvement and details of any help available. It will also warn that failure to improve may lead to dismissal or some other contractual penalty e.g. demotion. The employee shall be informed the Final Written Warning will be 'live' for 2 years and advised of their right to appeal against the warning. *Dismissal / Other Penalty* - If there has been further misconduct or failure to

3.4.5 improve performance since a final written warning, Loaded Dice may dismiss the employee or take some other action short of dismissal such as demotion or disciplinary suspension. The employee will be provided with a written statement of the reasons for dismissal/or other action, the date on which the employment will terminate (if dismissed), and their right to appeal, as soon as reasonably practicable.

3.4.6 *Dismissal without Notice* - If Loaded Dice establishes that there has been gross misconduct the employee may be summarily dismissed i.e. dismissed without notice. Loaded Dice will follow a fair disciplinary procedure before taking any decision to dismiss without notice and this will be confirmed in writing (see Gross Misconduct section below).

3.5 **Appeal**

3.5.1 Employees have the right to appeal against any formal disciplinary action. An appeal cannot be made against an informal verbal warning. The appeal should be made in writing within 5 working days of the disciplinary decision.

- 3.5.2 The employee must inform Loaded Dice as to the grounds for appeal in writing, and may be accompanied to the appeal meeting. In making an appeal, the employee should state if they are appealing against the finding that they committed the alleged acts of misconduct and/or against the level of sanction imposed.
- 3.5.3 Loaded Dice will hear the appeal without unreasonable delay and where possible the appeal will be dealt with by a manager, preferably more senior, not previously involved in the case. However, where this is not practicable, the same manager may handle both the disciplinary and the appeal meetings and he/she will act as impartially as possible. The outcome of the appeal will be confirmed in writing within 5
- 3.5.4 working days of the meeting. Decisions made at this stage will be final and there is no further right of internal appeal. The appeal outcome is final and marks the end of the internal
- 3.5.5 procedure.

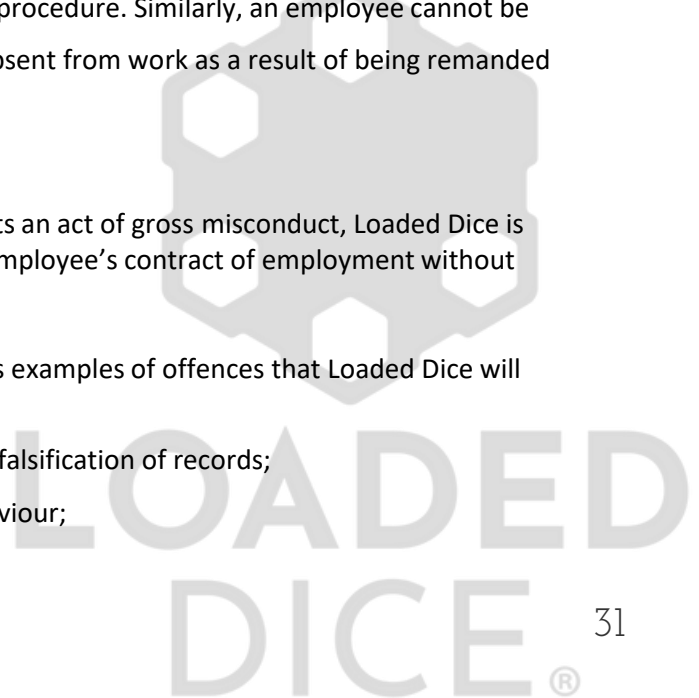
4. **Special Cases**

- 4.1 Where disciplinary action is being considered against an employee who is an accredited trade union representative of a trade union recognised by Loaded Dice for collective bargaining purposes, the above procedure will not be followed until Loaded Dice has had a chance to discuss the matter (with the prior agreement of the employee) with a senior trade union representative or permanent union official of that trade union. Loaded Dice shall, however, be able to suspend the employee in the case of a suspected or known incident gross misconduct. An employee being
- 4.2 charged or convicted with a criminal offence is not in itself a reason for disciplinary action. Loaded Dice will consider whether the offence or alleged offence is
 - a. One that makes the employee unsuitable for their type of work.
 - b. Relevance to the employee's role.
 - c. Risk to reputation.
 - d. Whether continuing employment is sustainable.

Therefore, Loaded Dice will establish the facts of the case and consider whether the facts warrant starting the disciplinary procedure. Similarly, an employee cannot be dismissed solely because they were absent from work as a result of being remanded in custody.

5. **Gross Misconduct**

- 5.1 In the event that an employee commits an act of gross misconduct, Loaded Dice is entitled to summarily terminate the employee's contract of employment without notice or pay in lieu of notice.
- 5.2 The following non-exhaustive list gives examples of offences that Loaded Dice will normally regard as gross misconduct:
 - 5.2.1 Theft, fraud, dishonesty or deliberate falsification of records;
 - 5.2.2 Fighting, assault or other violent behaviour;



- 5.2.3 Deliberate damage to, or misuse of, Company property; Deliberate use of internet
- 5.2.4 and/or email to access or distribute material of a pornographic, offensive, obscene or inappropriate nature;
- 5.2.5 Incapability at work due to the effect of alcohol or drugs;
- 5.2.6 Possession, custody or control of illegal drugs on Company premises;
- 5.2.7 Serious breach of the Company's rules, policies and procedures;
- 5.2.8 Serious negligence which causes loss, damage or injury;
- 5.2.9 Conviction of a criminal offence that is relevant to the employee's employment with the Company and renders them unsuitable for their work;
- 5.2.10 Conduct likely to bring the Company's name into disrepute;
- 5.2.11 Bullying, harassment, victimisation or discrimination;
- 5.2.12 Accepting bribes;
- 5.2.13 Serious breaches of the Company's anti-bribery policy;
- 5.2.14 Serious acts of insubordination.
- 5.2.15 Any other conduct which fundamentally breaches trust and confidence between employee and employer.
- 5.3 If Loaded Dice decides to summarily terminate the employee's contract of employment without notice or pay in lieu of notice, Loaded Dice will act *fairly and reasonably* to take this action rather than following the Disciplinary Procedure set out in Clause 3 above.

6. Data Protection

Loaded Dice shall process personal data collected during the investigation process and any subsequent disciplinary action in accordance with its Data Protection Policy. Data collected during the investigation process and subsequent disciplinary action will be held securely and accessed by, and disclosed to, individuals only for the purposes of completing the disciplinary procedure.

This procedure has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt
Position: Managing Director
Date: 23/9/25
Signature:

Graham Scutt





Grievance Procedure Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 22 Sept 2025

1. Purpose and Scope

Loaded Dice is committed to providing a fair, consistent, and timely process for dealing with employee concerns. This procedure ensures that any problems, complaints, or grievances are addressed appropriately.

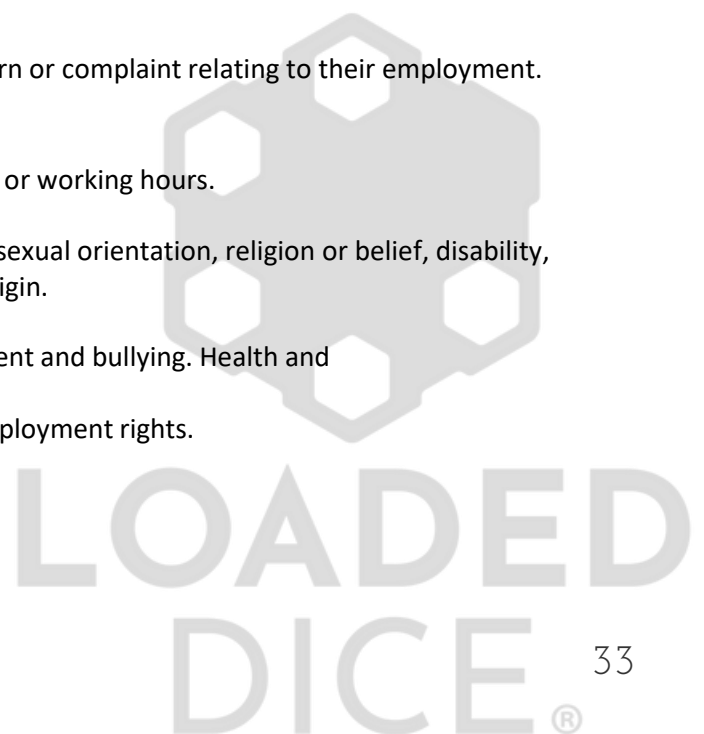
This policy applies to all employees of Loaded Dice.

Employees will not be treated unfavourably for raising a grievance in good faith, even if the complaint is not upheld.

2. Introduction

A grievance may arise when an employee has a concern or complaint relating to their employment. Examples include, but are not limited to:

- 2.1. Work, working conditions, pay and benefits, or working hours.
- 2.2. Discrimination on the grounds of race, sex, sexual orientation, religion or belief, disability, age, gender reassignment, marital status, or ethnic origin.
- 2.3. Treatment by colleagues, including harassment and bullying. Health and
- 2.4. safety concerns or breaches of statutory employment rights.
- 2.5. Any other issue affecting their employment.



Complaints regarding disciplinary action should be raised through the disciplinary appeal procedure, not this grievance procedure.

3. Informal Procedure

- 3.1. Where possible, employees should first raise their concern informally with their immediate manager. If the grievance involves the immediate manager, the employee should instead approach the next most senior manager.
- 3.2. The manager will discuss the concern with the employee and attempt to resolve the matter promptly, normally within 10 working days.
- 3.3. Both parties should keep a written record of any meeting, including what was discussed and any proposed action.
- 3.4. If the matter cannot be resolved informally, the employee may raise a formal grievance.

4. Formal Grievance Procedure

4.1. Written Statement

- 4.1.1. The employee should submit a written statement outlining the nature of their grievance to their line manager without unreasonable delay.
- 4.1.2. If the grievance concerns the line manager, the written statement should instead be sent to the Managing Director.

4.2. Grievance Meeting

- 4.2.1. The line manager will arrange a formal grievance meeting within 5 working days of receiving the statement, unless exceptional circumstances apply (in which case the employee will be informed in writing).
- 4.2.2. The manager must be given reasonable time to review the grievance before the meeting takes place.
- 4.2.3. A thorough investigation of the facts will be carried out before the meeting. Requests for anonymity or confidentiality will be considered where practicable.
- 4.2.4. The employee has the right to be accompanied by a colleague, a certified trade union representative, or an official employed by a trade union. The companion may address the meeting, support the employee, and confer with them but may not answer questions on their behalf.
- 4.2.5. Loaded Dice may refuse a companion if their presence could compromise the fairness or integrity of the process.
- 4.2.6. The employee, manager, and any companion must make every effort to attend the meeting. If the employee fails to attend without good reason, the meeting may proceed in their absence.

4.2.7. The employee should, where possible, explain how they believe the grievance could be resolved.

4.2.8. If further investigation is required, the meeting may be adjourned and reconvened once the investigation is complete.

4.3. Outcome of Meeting

4.3.1. Following the meeting (and any investigation), the manager will provide a written outcome, normally within 5 working days, setting out any decision and action to be taken.

4.3.2. The employee will also be informed of their right to appeal if they are dissatisfied with the outcome.

4.3.3. Any agreed actions will be monitored and reviewed as appropriate to ensure effectiveness.

4.4. Appeal

4.4.1. Employees have the right to appeal if they feel their grievance has not been satisfactorily resolved.

4.4.2. An appeal must be submitted in writing, stating the grounds for appeal, within 5 working days of receiving the written outcome.

4.4.3. A further meeting will be arranged within a reasonable timeframe. The employee will be informed in advance of the time and place.

4.4.4. The appeal will be impartial and, wherever possible, chaired by a manager not previously involved in the case and of greater seniority.

4.4.5. The appeal hearing is not a re-hearing of the original grievance, but a review of the specific grounds of dissatisfaction.

4.4.6. The employee has the right to be accompanied at the appeal meeting.

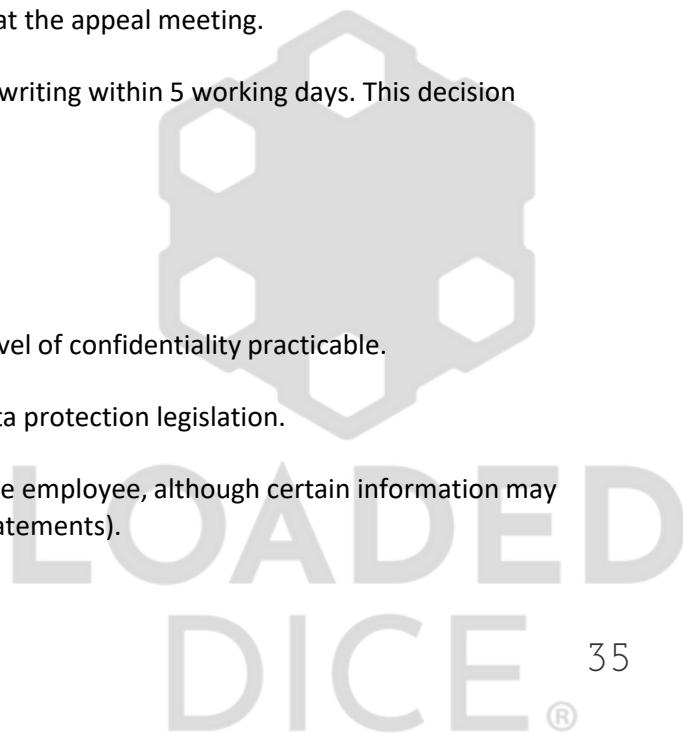
4.4.7. The outcome of the appeal will be confirmed in writing within 5 working days. This decision is final, and the grievance procedure is concluded.

5. Confidentiality

5.1. Grievances will be handled with the highest level of confidentiality practicable.

5.2. Records will be stored securely in line with data protection legislation.

5.3. Copies of meeting notes will be provided to the employee, although certain information may be withheld to protect confidentiality (e.g., witness statements).



6. Special Cases

- 6.1. Where a grievance is raised during a disciplinary process, the disciplinary process may be temporarily suspended if the grievance is directly related to the case.
- 6.2. This procedure does not apply to collective grievances.
- 6.3. Separate procedures exist for concerns involving bullying, harassment, or whistleblowing, particularly where serious misconduct, legal breaches, or regulatory obligations are involved.

This procedure has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt

Position: Managing Director

Date: 23/9/25

Signature: *Graham Scutt*



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Records Retention Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 22 Sept 2025

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Records Retention Policy is to ensure that Loaded Dice manages its business records responsibly, in compliance with applicable UK legislation, regulatory requirements, and best practice standards.

This policy:

- Sets out how long records are retained. Provides guidance for secure storage, access, and disposal. Ensures compliance with the UK GDPR, the Data Protection Act 2018, and other relevant laws. Balances operational needs with data minimisation and privacy obligations.

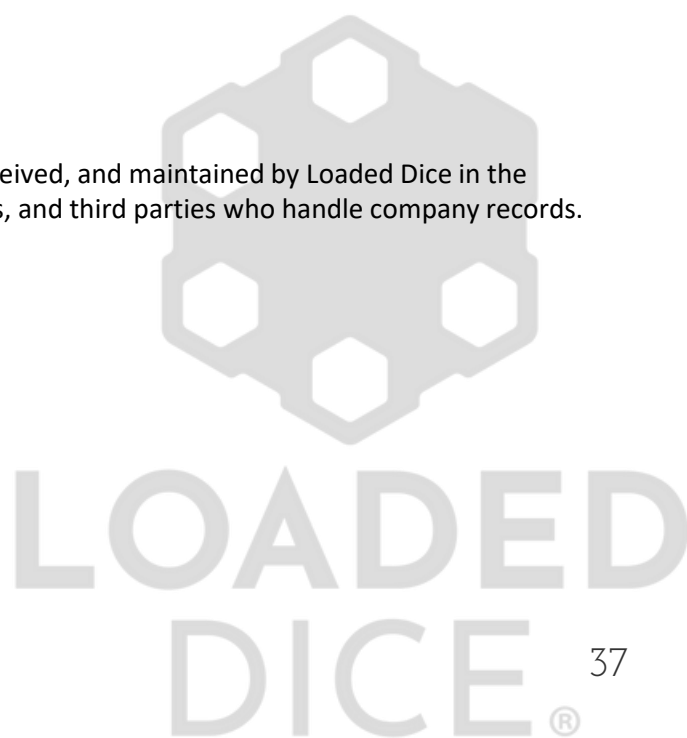
2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All records (paper and electronic) created, received, and maintained by Loaded Dice in the course of business. All employees, contractors, and third parties who handle company records.

Records include but are not limited to:

- Personnel and HR files
- Financial and accounting records
- Contracts and agreements
- Client and customer data
- Corporate governance documents
- Health and safety records



- Emails and electronic communications

3. Policy Statement

Loaded Dice will:

- Retain records for the minimum period required by law or business necessity.
- Not retain records longer than necessary.
- Regularly review records to ensure they are current, accurate, and lawfully held.
- Dispose of records securely and irretrievably once the retention period has expired.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

- Board of Directors / Senior Management: Overall accountability for compliance.
 - Data Protection Officer (DPO) / Information Governance Lead: Ensures compliance with UK GDPR and advises on data minimisation.
 - Department Heads: Ensure adherence to retention schedules in their business areas.
- All Staff: Follow this policy when creating, storing, and disposing of records.

5. Retention Periods

Retention periods will follow statutory requirements and industry best practices. Examples include:

Record Type	Retention Period	Legal/Regulatory Reference
Personnel files (general)	6 years after employment ends	Limitation Act 1980
Payroll, tax, and NI records	6 years	HMRC requirements
Contracts and agreements	6 years after termination 3 years minimum	Limitation Act 1980 RIDDOR 2013
Health & safety records (e.g., accident reports)		
Medical records (work-related exposure)	40 years	COSHH 2002
Accounting records	6 years	Companies Act 2006
VAT records	6 years Permanently	HMRC requirements Companies Act 2006
Board minutes and statutory registers		
Marketing data (prospects, leads interest)	Until consent withdrawn or 2 years inactivity	UK GDPR (consent/legitimate)

A detailed retention schedule will be maintained as an appendix to this policy.

6. Secure Storage

- Physical records must be stored in locked, access-controlled areas.
- Electronic records must be stored on secure servers with access restricted to authorised users.
- Cloud storage providers must meet UK GDPR standards.

7. Disposal of Records

- Paper records must be cross-shredded or disposed of via an approved secure destruction service.

- Electronic records must be securely deleted or destroyed so they cannot be reconstructed. A
- disposal log must be maintained for high-risk or sensitive records.

8. Data Subject Rights Under the UK GDPR, individuals have rights to access, rectify, erase, or restrict

processing of their personal data. Retention of personal data will always respect these rights, unless an overriding legal obligation requires otherwise.

9. Monitoring and Review

This policy will be:

- Reviewed annually by the DPO.
- Updated in line with changes to UK law, regulations, or business needs.

10. Breach of Policy

Failure to follow this policy may result in disciplinary action and could expose [Company Name] to legal, financial, or reputational risks.

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt

Position: Managing Director

Date: 23/9/25

Signature:

Graham Scutt



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Sickness and Absence Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 22 Sept 2025

1. Introduction

This policy is designed to assist Loaded Dice in effectively managing sickness-related and other staff absence. Loaded Dice values supporting employees during sickness and absences and their subsequent return to work. Through an effective Sickness and Absence Policy, Loaded Dice will be better positioned to identify any potentially unsafe work practices, any issues affecting employee morale and any other underlying problems employees may be facing.

Any and all information provided by employees to Loaded Dice about their health (including, but not limited to forms and medical records) will be collected, held, and processed lawfully and in accordance with Loaded Dice Data Protection Policy. Loaded Dice recognises that such data is sensitive and will handle it accordingly and in accordance with employee's rights under the law.

Sickness Absence

2. **Notification of Sickness** If an employee is unable to come to work for any reason, they must
 - 2.1 inform Loaded Dice by contacting the Assistant Managing Director as soon as reasonably possible.
 - 2.2 Employees should speak to the Assistant Managing Director personally i.e. calls on the employee's behalf from a friend/partner/parent will only be acceptable in exceptional circumstances. Employees may contact by email or text if they are unable to reach the Assistant Managing Director due to extenuating circumstances such as illness or emergency.
 - 2.3 The employee should indicate the reason for their absence, it's likely duration and when the illness started.
 - 2.4 In the event that the employee's absence continues for a number of days or weeks, they must maintain regular contact with the Assistant Managing Director to keep Loaded Dice informed of the reasons for their ongoing absence and the date when they expect to be able to return

to work. In such cases the employee should specify how the Assistant Managing Director can contact them if necessary, ideally leaving a landline number on which they can be contacted.

3. **Certification of Sickness** All periods of absence through sickness must be certified by the
 - 3.1 statutory Form SC2. The completed form should indicate actual days of sickness, even if they include days when the employee would not normally have worked (e.g. weekends and public holidays).
 - 3.2 For sickness absences of up to 5 calendar days, the self-certification form should be completed by the employee upon their return to work and handed to the Assistant Managing Director
 - 3.3 Employees are required to submit a medical certificate, the statutory Form Med 3 also referred to as a 'fit note' within 7 days for absences lasting longer than 5 days. This will provide us with more information about your condition, and let us know whether your GP or medical provider considers that you are not 'fit for work', or 'may be fit for work taking account of the following advice'. Subsequent medical certificates must be produced as necessary to cover the total duration of the period of absence. As a minimum, employees should contact their manager on a weekly basis to provide an update on the injury or illness.
4. **Long-Term and Persistent Absence**
 - 4.1 Loaded Dice are committed to working with employees during long-term illness and will explore all reasonable adjustments to help facilitate their return to work. Loaded Dice will treat as long-term absence any period of extensive absence due to serious or significant illness over a prolonged period. Persistent absence may consist of a series of unconnected short-term illnesses. Where Loaded Dice is of the opinion that a period of absence is long-term, it will inform the employee of such and:
 - 4.1.1 require that the employee keep in regular contact with Loaded Dice, at such intervals as agreed between the Assistant Managing Director and the employee; and
 - 4.1.2 ensure that the employee is kept informed as to any possible threat to their employment.
 - 4.2 Loaded Dice reserves the right to request a home visit where the illness is long-term. The purpose of the visit will be to discuss possibilities for a return to work and to discover whether Loaded Dice can assist in facilitating this. This visit will be arranged only if necessary and after other options (such as video calls) have been considered.
 - 4.3 Loaded Dice will treat as persistent absence a series of unconnected short-term illnesses.
 - 4.4 It may be necessary in incidences of long-term or persistent absence to treat the matter as an issue of capability or conduct. In such circumstances Loaded Dice will:
 - 4.4.1 investigate the absence through "Return to Work Interviews" and the obtaining of medical reports;
 - 4.4.2 set time limits on the assessment of the employee and keep him or her informed of such;
 - 4.4.3 consider adjustments to the job in order to facilitate a return to work or to allow the employee to do their job more easily, for example the implementation of flexible working arrangements;

4.4.4 consider whether the illness amounts to a disability. Where it is found to do so the employee shall fall under the scope of the Loaded Dice Equal Opportunities and Diversity Policy and Loaded Dice shall make such reasonable adjustments as are necessary; and

keep the employee informed in all the circumstance of any threat to their employment.

4.5 Where Loaded Dice requires medical reports relating to an absence it will either:

4.5.1 request that the employee undergo an independent medical examination or

4.5.2 obtain a report from the employee's doctor and/or the Fit for Work assessment service, subject to employee consent.

4.5.3 Loaded Dice will make every effort to discuss any medical concerns with the employee before requesting an independent medical examination. Employees will be informed in advance of any such request.

In either case the employee may refuse to attend or refuse to consent to the release of a medical report, or request that corrections are made. Employees are reminded however that any decision regarding their future which could result in dismissal will be taken on the basis of the information available to Loaded Dice.

4.6 Loaded Dice will hold all medical reports and related information obtained under Clause 4.5 as private and confidential and all such information will be handled in accordance with the Loaded Dice Data Protection Policy.

4.7 Loaded Dice stresses that dismissal will only ever be taken as a last resort. Where however the absence is found to be a matter of misconduct, the employee will be subject to Loaded Dice disciplinary policy.

5. **Sickness Which Occurs Whilst the Employee is on Holiday**

5.1 Where an employee is incapacitated through sickness or injury during any period of pre-booked holiday (whether in whole or in part), Loaded Dice will, subject to the correct notification and certification, allow the employee to transfer to sick leave and take replacement holiday at a later date. This policy is subject to the following conditions, which will be strictly applied:

5.1.1 The total period of incapacity must be fully certificated by a qualified medical practitioner [where it exceeds 7 days;]

5.1.2 The employee must contact the Assistant Managing Director or the Managing Director (in person and by telephone if possible) as soon as they know that there will be a period of incapacity during the holiday; and

5.1.3 The employee must confirm in writing to Assistant Managing Director no later than 48 hours after returning to work how much of the holiday period was affected by sickness or injury and the amount of leave that the employee wishes to take at another time.

5.2 Any requests for replacement holiday must be made in accordance with Loaded Dice holiday policy and the employee should try to take the replacement holiday in the holiday year in which it was accrued. Where this is not possible, Loaded Dice will allow the employee to carry forward the leave into the next holiday year.

5.3 Loaded Dice may require the employee to take all or part of their replacement holiday on particular days to be specified by the Assistant Managing Director.

6. Return to Work Interviews

LoadedDice shall decide, after any absence due to sickness, whether the employee is required to attend a return-to-work interview with the Assistant Managing Director in order to:

- 6.1 ensure the employee's fitness to return to work.
- 6.2 agree any necessary actions required to facilitate the employee's return to work.
- 6.3 ensure the proper certificates (e.g. Fit Note or Fit for Work return-to-work plan) have been completed/obtained in respect of the entire period of absence; and
- 6.4 discuss any problems that may exist.

Return-to-work interviews aim to support employees in their transition back to work, ensuring that the employee's well-being and any adjustments needed are discussed in a positive, open manner. At the return-to-work interview, employees may be set reasonable targets and time limits for an improvement in attendance. A failure to improve may result in disciplinary action.

SICK PAY

7. Statutory Sick Pay (SSP)

- 7.1 In order to be eligible for SSP, employees must be ill for four days or longer (this can include weekends and bank holidays) and must have average weekly earnings equal to or more than the lower earnings limit. Please see relevant government websites such as HMRC and Gov.uk for details of the current lower earnings limit.
- 7.2 Employees must use the statutory Form SC2 to provide the Company with details of their illness.
- 7.3 The present weekly SSP rate can be found on relevant government websites such as HMRC and Gov.uk.
- 7.4 The Company will record all details of SSP payments made to employees using Statutory Form SSP2 in conjunction with legal requirements.
- 7.5

Where the Company is not required to pay SSP or SSP comes to an end, the Company will provide the employee with Form SSP1 to support the employee's claim for Employment and Support Allowance.]

8. Company Sick Pay (CSP) Loaded Dice sick pay is entirely discretionary and does not form part

- 8.1 of an employee's contractual entitlement. Loaded Dice reserves the right to withhold or withdraw such payments at its sole discretion, and no precedent shall be established by any previous payment. Statutory entitlements will remain unaffected.
- 8.2 To be considered for CSP, the employee must have completed at least 3 months continuous service with Loaded Dice and have complied with Clauses 2 and 3 above. Entitlement to CSP is determined according to the employee's length of continuous service, as follows:

[First 3 months]	[Statutory Sick Pay only] 1 week's full basic
[3 - 24 months]	pay [1 week's full basic and 2 weeks' half
[2 - 5 years]	basic
	pay]
[5 years or more]	[2 weeks' full basic and 4 week's half basic pay]

- 8.3 Where Loaded Dice makes full payment in times of illness or injury, this includes any entitlement to statutory sick pay (SSP). Where Loaded Dice pays half pay, SSP will be added but the total of company pay and SSP will not exceed normal full basic pay.

- 8.4 The employee will forfeit entitlement to CSP if:

- 8.4.1 They fail to comply with notification and certification requirements.
- 8.4.2 They make or produce any misleading or untrue statement or document concerning their fitness to work.
- 8.4.3 Their incapacity has been caused by participation in dangerous sports or activities.
- 8.4.4 If the absence is determined to be due to misconduct.

- 8.4 Employees will be notified in writing of their sick pay entitlement and any changes to their pay during a period of illness.

Other Absences

9. **Jury Service** Any employee called for jury service should inform the Assistant Managing

- 9.1 Director as soon as they are summoned.

- 9.2 Employees called for jury service will not be paid by Loaded Dice for the period of their absence. Employees should instead claim all available allowances from the Court.

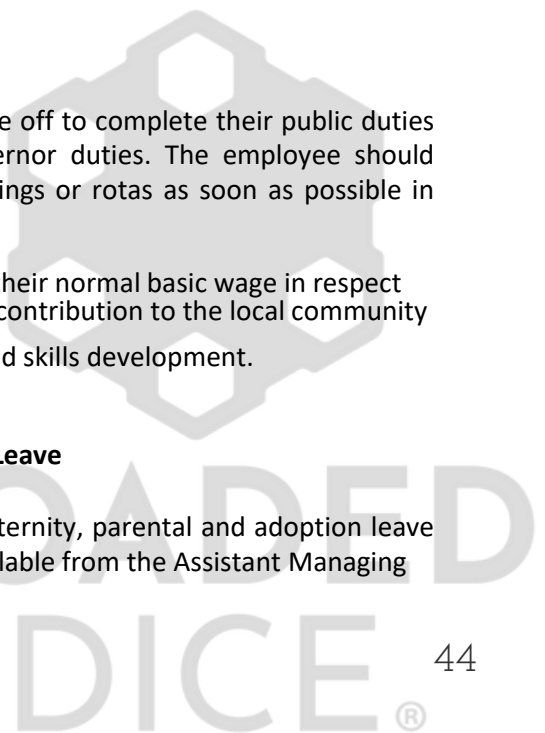
10. Public Duties

- 10.1 Loaded Dice is legally obliged to permit any employee time off to complete their public duties including, but not limited to, magistrate or school governor duties. The employee should inform Assistant Managing Director of their duties, meetings or rotas as soon as possible in order to allow the Company time to plan for their absence.

- 10.2 Loaded Dice will pay employees carrying out public duties their normal basic wage in respect of practical time off for such duties, in recognition of their contribution to the local community and the benefits that the Company derives from their added skills development.

11. Emergency, Maternity, Paternity, Parental and Adoption Leave

- 11.1 Emergency leave (time off for dependants), maternity, paternity, parental and adoption leave are all dealt with in their respective policy documents, available from the Assistant Managing



- Director. If employees are uncertain about any other type of absence they must ask for advice from the Assistant Managing Director. Other types of absence may be covered by separate company policies and procedures and/or by statutory rights. Unauthorised absence is likely to be treated as a disciplinary offence.
- 11.2

12 Trade Union

The Company is legally obliged to allow employees time off to carry out their trade union duties. Any time taken off will be paid unless the carrying out of such duties occurs outside working hours.

13. **Monitoring** Loaded Dice will monitor and record levels of absence and reasons for absence in order to help identify abuse of this policy, which places additional stress on colleagues. Further Loaded Dice will be better positioned to identify unsatisfactory work practices and to distinguish between different types of absence.
- 13.1
- 13.2 Loaded Dice will obtain consent from each employee, either in their Terms and Conditions of employment, or on a separate consent form to comply with the relevant Data Protection legislation and the Loaded Dice Data Protection Policy.
- 13.3 All information gathered through absence monitoring under this Policy will be held and treated in confidence and will be collected, held, and processed lawfully and in accordance with the Loaded Dice Data Protection Policy.

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt
Position: Managing Director
Date: 23/9/25
Signature:

Graham Scutt



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Opening and Closing of Loaded Dice Property Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 24 Sept 2025

1. **Purpose** This policy outlines the responsibilities and procedures for opening and closing company property to ensure the security of personnel, assets, and facilities.

2. **Scope**

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and authorized personnel responsible for opening or closing any company-owned or leased facility.

3. **Responsibilities**

- **Designated Personnel:** Only employees specifically assigned and trained may open or close company property.
- **Supervisors/Managers:** Ensure staff are trained in these procedures and update assignments as necessary.
- **Employees:** Must follow all procedures without deviation unless authorized by management.
- **Key/Access Holders:** Employees with access to company keys and alarm fobs must bring them to work each day and keep them secured at all times.

4. **Opening Procedures**

- Arrival** 4.1. Arrive at least 15 minutes prior to scheduled opening time.
4.2. Ensure the area around the entrance is safe and clear of suspicious activity.

Unlocking 4.3. Use assigned access credentials (key, fob, or code).

4.4. Disarm the security system immediately upon entry.

Initial Check 4.5. Conduct a walkthrough of the premises to confirm no unauthorized entry or safety hazards.

4.6. Report any irregularities to management immediately.

Preparation for Business 4.7. Turn on lights, HVAC, and other necessary equipment.

4.8. Ensure entryways are unlocked for staff/customers at the scheduled time.

5. Closing Procedures

End-of-Day Checks 5.1. Confirm all staff and visitors have exited the premises.

5.2. Secure sensitive materials (documents, cash, equipment) in designated storage.

6. Shut Down

6.1. Turn off non-essential equipment, lights, and appliances.

6.2. Lock internal storage rooms, offices, or restricted areas as required.

7. Final Lock-Up

7.1. Lock all exterior doors and windows.

7.2. Arm the security system.

7.3. Double-check perimeter security (gates, fences, or exterior locks).

8. **Exit** 8.1. Leave the premises promptly after securing.

8.2. Do not remain on-site after closing unless authorized by management.

Security and Safety 9.1. Keys, codes, or access cards must not be shared with unauthorized

9. individuals.

9.2. Employees must immediately report any lost, stolen, or forgotten keys or alarm fobs to

management.

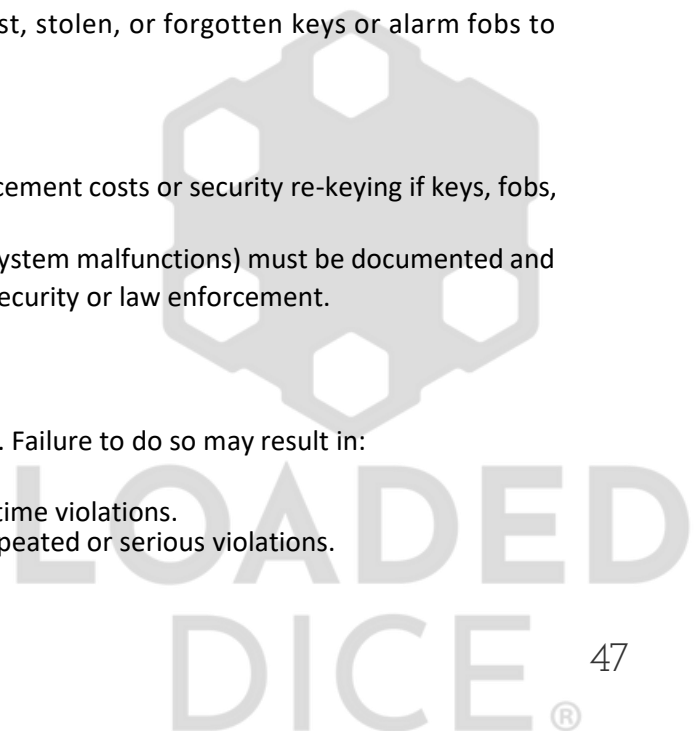
9.3. Employees may be held responsible for replacement costs or security re-keying if keys, fobs, or access devices are lost due to negligence.

9.4. Any incidents (break-ins, suspicious activity, system malfunctions) must be documented and reported to management and, if necessary, security or law enforcement.

10. Compliance

All employees are expected to comply with this policy. Failure to do so may result in:

- **Verbal or Written Warning** for minor or first-time violations.
- **Suspension or Loss of Access Privileges** for repeated or serious violations.



- **Financial Responsibility** for replacement costs or re-keying when loss occurs due to negligence. **Termination of Employment** for wilful disregard of security procedures, repeated violations, or behaviour that places company property or personnel at risk.

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt

Position: Managing Director

Date: 23/9/25

Signature: *Graham Scutt*





Alcohol Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 22 Sept 2025

1. Introduction

Loaded Dice is committed to being a responsible employer and ensuring the health, safety, and welfare of all employees. Alcohol-related problems can affect an employee's wellbeing, safety, and performance, and may also impact colleagues, customers, and the wider workplace.

This policy sets out our approach to alcohol consumption, our expectations of employees, and the support available for those who may develop alcohol-related problems. It also helps ensure compliance with the Health and Safety at Work Act 1974, which places a duty on employers to provide a safe working environment and to protect the health and safety of employees, visitors, and contractors.

2. Aims of the Policy

This policy aims to:

- Promote awareness of alcohol-related risks and addiction. Encourage a sensible and
- responsible approach to alcohol consumption. Ensure compliance with legal and
- health and safety obligations. Set clear restrictions on alcohol use in the workplace.
- Protect employees from the risks associated with alcohol misuse. Provide support to
- employees who may be experiencing alcohol-related difficulties. Establish fair and
- consistent procedures for managing alcohol-related issues.

3. Health, Safety and Performance

While moderate drinking is accepted in many social settings, alcohol consumption in the workplace can:



- Impair performance and decision-making.
- Lead to inappropriate or unsafe behaviour.
- Place the individual and colleagues at risk.
- Have a negative impact on health over time.

Alcohol misuse in the workplace may take two forms:

- **Occasional inappropriate drinking** — often managed as misconduct.
- **Consistent or long-term misuse** — more likely to involve health and performance concerns.

Signs of possible alcohol misuse may include:

- Frequent or unexplained absences.
- Unusually high sickness levels, particularly around weekends.
- Decline in appearance or hygiene.
- Irregular work patterns or reduced productivity.
- Difficulty maintaining good working relationships.

These indicators do not, on their own, prove alcohol misuse, but concerns should be raised confidentially with a manager.

4. Restrictions on Alcohol Use

- Employees must not consume alcohol during working hours unless formal approval has been given by the Managing Director.
- Employees must not attend work or represent Loaded Dice while unfit for duty due to alcohol.
- Alcohol should not be consumed in excess while attending business functions, events, or hospitality on behalf of Loaded Dice.
- Employees are not required to work with anyone they reasonably believe is unfit due to alcohol. Concerns should be reported immediately to a manager.

Employees who are unfit for duty because of alcohol will be removed from duty and the matter referred for further action.

If an accident or incident occurs while an employee is under the influence of alcohol, the employee may be held personally responsible in addition to any Loaded Dice liability.

5. Support for Employees

Loaded Dice recognises that alcohol dependency can be a medical condition and will treat it as a health matter where possible. Employees are encouraged to seek help at an early stage. Support may include:

- Confidential discussions with a manager or HR.
- Referral to occupational health or counselling services.
- Signposting to external specialist organisations.

All requests for support will be treated in the strictest confidence and any information gathered will be managed in line with the Loaded Dice Data Protection Policy.

6. Procedure



1. Concerns about alcohol misuse should be reported confidentially to the employee's line manager or HR.
2. The employee will be invited to a private meeting to discuss the concern.
3. Where appropriate, referral to occupational health or an external service may be arranged.
4. Medical advice may be sought to confirm whether an alcohol-related condition exists.
5. If the employee agrees to follow an appropriate treatment plan, disciplinary action may be paused while support is provided.
6. Adjustments may be considered, such as lighter duties or short periods of leave, where appropriate.
7. Following successful treatment, Loaded Dice will seek to return the employee to their role or, if not possible, an alternative suitable position.
8. In cases of repeated relapse, Loaded Dice may not be able to continue providing support, and disciplinary action up to and including dismissal may follow.

7. Disciplinary Action

- Employees who attend work unfit through alcohol may be subject to disciplinary action under Loaded Dice disciplinary policy.
 - Being unfit for duty through alcohol may amount to gross misconduct, which could lead to summary dismissal.
- Disciplinary action may also apply if alcohol misuse leads to misconduct, unsafe behaviour, or damage to Loaded Dice reputation.

8. Responsibility for Implementation

- Line managers are responsible for monitoring performance and behaviour, addressing concerns, and referring issues appropriately.
 - The Assistant Managing Director will oversee policy implementation and ensure employees are treated fairly and consistently.
- Employees are responsible for ensuring they are fit for duty and for raising concerns about their own or others' fitness to work.

9. Review of Policy This policy will be reviewed every two years, or earlier if there are changes in legislation or Loaded Dice practice.

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt
 Position: Managing Director
 Date: 23/9/25
 Signature:

Graham Scutt



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Drugs Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 22 Sept 2025

1. Introduction

Loaded Dice is committed to providing a safe, healthy, and supportive working environment. This policy sets out our approach to drug use and misuse, helping us to protect the health, safety, and welfare of all employees, and to comply with our legal duties.

Legal framework:

- Section 2(2)(e) of the Health and Safety at Work Act 1974 requires employers to provide a safe and healthy working environment.
- The Misuse of Drugs Act 1971 makes it an offence to supply, produce, or permit the supply or use of controlled drugs on premises.

It is also an offence to aid or abet any of these offences.

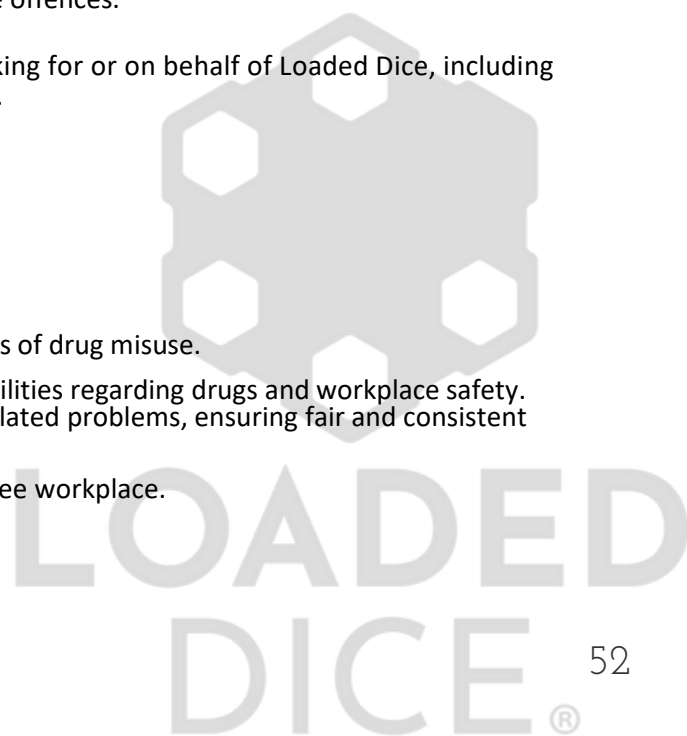
This policy applies to all employees and anyone working for or on behalf of Loaded Dice, including contractors, consultants, agency staff, and volunteers.

2. Aims of the Policy

This policy aims to:

- Comply with legal requirements.
 - Promote awareness of the risks and symptoms of drug misuse.
 - Ensure employees understand their responsibilities regarding drugs and workplace safety.
 - Support employees who seek help for drug-related problems, ensuring fair and consistent treatment.
- Safeguard all employees by ensuring a drug-free workplace.

3. Health and Safety



Being under the influence of drugs at work can endanger the individual and others. Drug misuse may result in reduced attendance, lower efficiency and performance, impaired judgement, and increased accidents.

Possible signs of misuse may include:

- Noticeable or unexplained changes in behaviour;
- Confusion or disorientation;
- Irritability or mood swings;
- Fluctuations in energy levels;
- Decline in performance;
- Increased short-term sickness absence.

Employees who are concerned about a colleague are encouraged to:

- Urge the colleague to seek help; and/or
- Raise the matter confidentially with their line manager or HR.

Concerns must not be discussed with other colleagues.

Employees taking prescribed medication must seek medical advice about any impact on their ability to work safely and inform HR or their line manager if adjustments are needed.

4. Searches

Loaded Dice reserves the right to conduct searches for drugs on Loaded Dice premises, including bags, lockers, and cabinets.

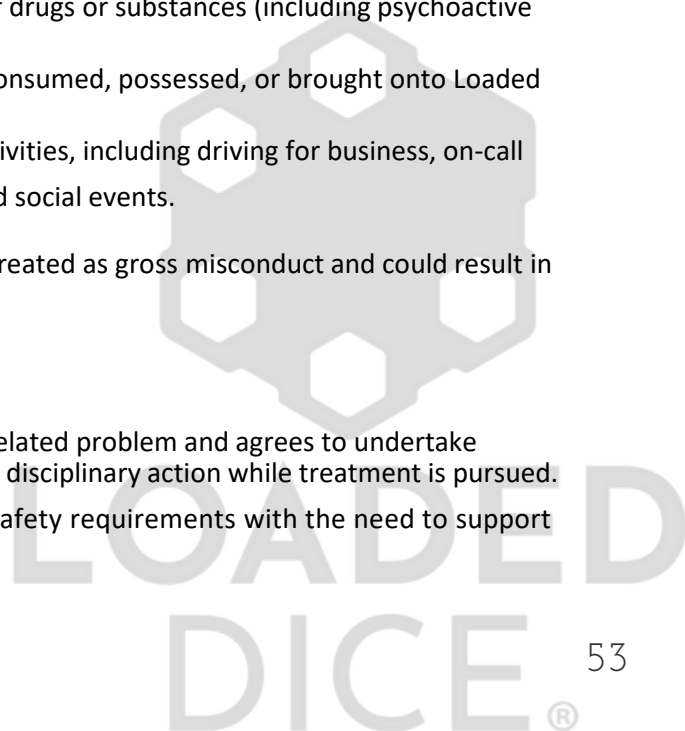
Searches will be conducted respectfully and, where possible, in the presence of a witness. Employees may request a colleague to be present.

5. Prohibition

- Employees must be fit for work and able to perform their duties safely and effectively.
 - Employees must not be under the influence of drugs or substances (including psychoactive substances, formerly known as “legal highs”).
- Controlled or illegal substances must not be consumed, possessed, or brought onto Loaded Dice premises, land, or vehicles at any time. This prohibition applies to all work-related activities, including driving for business, on-call duties, business trips, training, or work-related social events.

6. Disciplinary Action Breaches of this policy may be treated as gross misconduct and could result in disciplinary action up to and including dismissal.

However, if an employee voluntarily declares a drug-related problem and agrees to undertake treatment or rehabilitation, Loaded Dice may suspend disciplinary action while treatment is pursued. Each case will be considered individually, balancing safety requirements with the need to support employees.



7. Principles

- All information about an employee's health, including drug-related matters, will be handled in accordance with Loaded Dice Data Protection Policy.
- A drug-related problem will be treated as a health matter wherever possible, without excusing related misconduct or poor performance.
- Employees will be supported sympathetically and constructively and signposted to sources of further help.
- Requests for help will be treated in strict confidence, although some limited information-sharing may be necessary to provide support.
- Loaded Dice may, where appropriate, temporarily adjust duties or grant paid leave to support treatment.
- Following successful treatment, employees will normally be returned to their previous role or a suitable alternative.

In cases of relapse, further support may be offered at Loaded Dice discretion. Repeated breaches of this policy may result in dismissal.

If it is identified that the working environment contributes to drug-related problems, Loaded Dice will take reasonable steps to address those factors.

8. Responsibilities

Managers are responsible for:

- Ensuring all staff are aware of this policy and the standards expected.
- Taking action when behaviour falls below requirements.
- Supporting staff who seek help, in line with this policy.

Employees are responsible for:

- Ensuring they are fit for work.
- Seeking help if they experience drug-related issues.
- Supporting colleagues appropriately by raising concerns through the correct channels.

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt
Position: Managing Director
Date: 23/9/25

Signature: *Graham Scutt*



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Bringing Your Own Devices to Work (BYOD) Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 22 Sept 2025

1. Introduction This policy applies to all employees who use personal devices (e.g., laptops, smartphones, tablets, or removable media) to access Loaded Dice systems, applications, or data.

The purpose of this policy is to protect the security and integrity of Loaded Dice information and technology infrastructure while allowing employees the flexibility to use personal devices for work.

This policy must be read in conjunction with the Communications, Email, and Internet Policy and the Data Protection Policy.

Employees may only connect personal devices to Loaded Dice systems with prior written approval from the Managing Director (or delegate) and by agreeing to comply with this policy.



2. Acceptable Use 2.1 Permitted Uses

Employees may use personal devices for:

- Business activities that support Loaded Dice operations. Reasonable and limited personal use (e.g., brief personal calls, reading, light recreation).

2.2 Prohibited Uses Devices

must not be used to:

- Store or transmit unlawful, offensive, or discriminatory material. Store or
- transmit proprietary information belonging to another organisation. Harass,
- bully, or defame others. Conduct personal business activities.
-

Employees may access Loaded Dice resources (e.g., email, calendars, contacts, documents, and approved social media accounts) only through secure company-authorised applications.

3. Data Protection and GDPR Compliance

Loaded Dice is the data controller for all work-related personal data stored on employee devices. The Data Protection Officer (DPO) is responsible for overseeing compliance with this policy.

Employees must comply with GDPR principles when handling personal data, which means:

Using data only for legitimate business purposes.

Ensuring data is accurate, relevant, and up-to-date.

Keeping data secure and deleting it when no longer needed.

Reporting loss, unauthorised access, or suspected breaches immediately to the DPO.

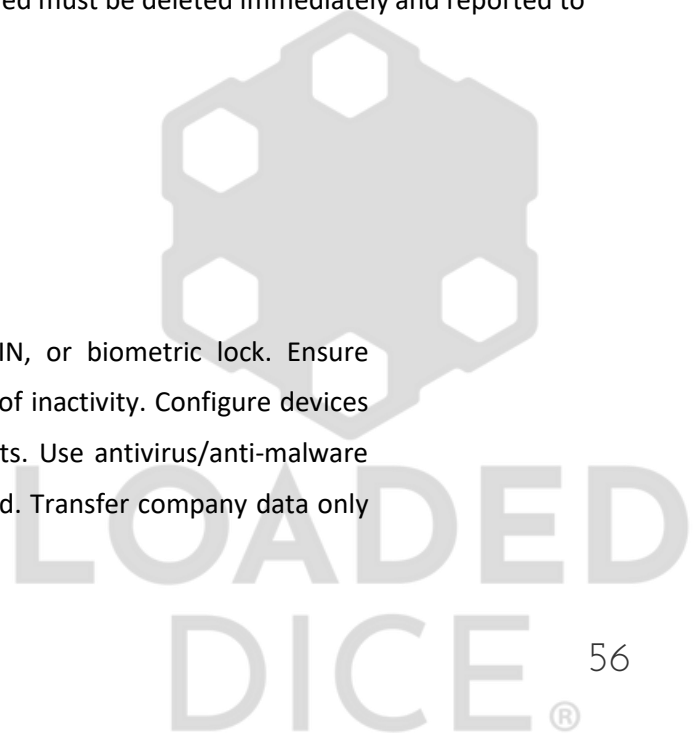
Employees must not create, process, or store special category data (e.g., health, race, religion, sexual orientation) on personal devices. Any such data received must be deleted immediately and reported to the DPO.

4. Employees' Obligations

4.1 Security

Employees must:

- Protect devices with a strong password, PIN, or biometric lock. Ensure
- devices lock automatically after five minutes of inactivity. Configure devices
- to lock after several failed password attempts. Use antivirus/anti-malware
- software and keep operating systems updated. Transfer company data only
- via encrypted channels (e.g., VPN).



- Avoid downloading unverified or insecure applications. Avoid connecting to
- unsecured Wi-Fi networks. Report any device loss, theft, or suspected
- breach immediately to the DPO.

Employees agree that Loaded Dice may require remote wiping of work-related data from a personal device in cases of loss, theft, breach, or upon termination of employment.

4.2 Devices and Support

- Devices must be presented for provisioning and configuration before connecting to Loaded Dice systems.
- Employees are responsible for the cost, maintenance, and repair of personal devices unless otherwise agreed.
- IT support for personal devices will be limited to installation of required apps and security tools.

4.3 Subject Access Requests If a data subject submits an access request under GDPR, Loaded Dice may need to retrieve relevant information stored on a personal device. Employees must cooperate with such requests. Searches will be limited to the necessary data only.

4.4 Retention and Deletion of Data

- Work-related personal data must not be stored longer than necessary. Deleted data must be
- permanently erased, not simply moved to a recycle or trash folder. If removable media (e.g.,
- USB drives, CDs) is used, data must be deleted once transfer is complete.

4.5 End of Employment Before leaving the company, employees must:

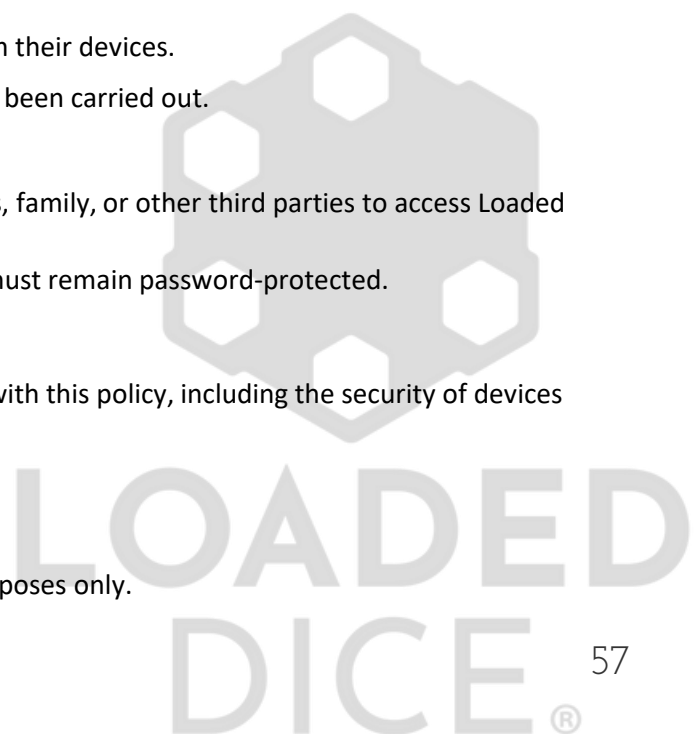
- Permanently delete all work-related data from their devices.
- Allow verification by IT/DPO that deletion has been carried out.

4.6 Third-Party Use Employees must not allow friends, family, or other third parties to access Loaded Dice information on their devices. All Loaded Dice-related apps and data must remain password-protected.

5. Monitoring Loaded Dice may monitor compliance with this policy, including the security of devices accessing Loaded Dice data.

Monitoring will be:

- Proportionate and for legitimate business purposes only.



- Limited to what is necessary for compliance, security, or legal reasons.
- Undertaken with employees' knowledge and consent.

Employees consent to such monitoring as a condition of connecting personal devices to Loaded Dice systems.

6. Non-Compliance Breaches of this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal. In serious cases, employees may also be personally liable for breaches under data protection law.

7. Review and Training

- Loaded Dice will provide mandatory data protection and IT security training to all employees on a regular basis.
- This policy will be reviewed annually or following significant legal, regulatory, or technological changes.

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt

Position: Managing Director

Date: 23/9/25

Signature: *Graham Scutt*



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Anti-Bribery and Corruption Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 24 Sept 2025

Anti-Bribery and Corruption Policy

1. Purpose

Loaded Dice is committed to acting with integrity and conducting business in an honest, transparent, and ethical way. We have a zero-tolerance approach to bribery and corruption and expect the same from everyone working with or for us.

This Policy helps ensure compliance with the Bribery Act 2010 and applies to all employees, contractors, consultants, business partners, agents, and anyone else representing the Company.

2. What is Bribery? Bribery is offering, giving, requesting, or receiving something of value to

improperly influence a decision or action.

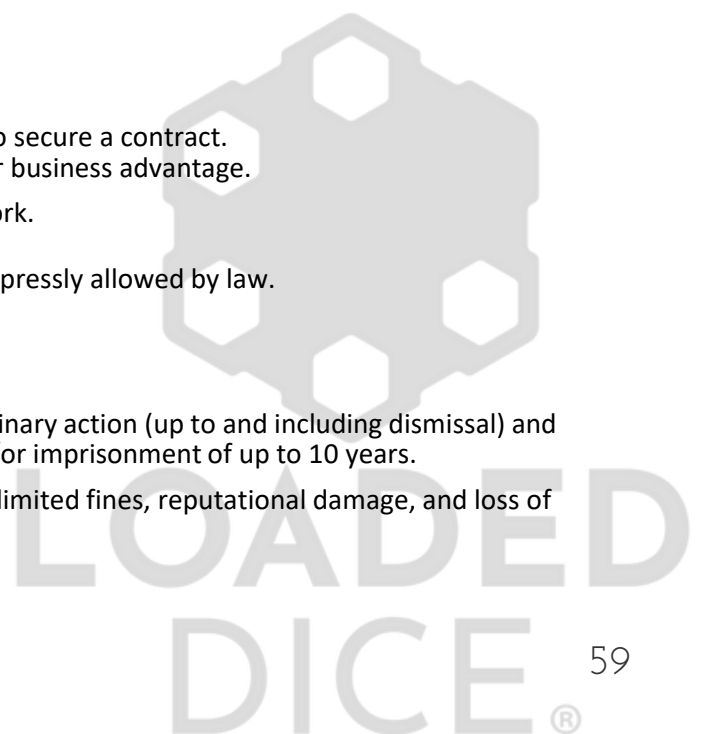
Examples include:

- Paying or accepting money, gifts, or favours to secure a contract.
- Offering excessive hospitality to gain an unfair business advantage.
- Requesting benefits in return for awarding work.

Bribery of foreign officials is also prohibited, unless expressly allowed by law.

3. Consequences of Bribery

- **For individuals:** Breaches may result in disciplinary action (up to and including dismissal) and could lead to criminal prosecution, fines, and/or imprisonment of up to 10 years.
- **For the Company:** A breach could result in unlimited fines, reputational damage, and loss of business.



4. Responsibilities

- Everyone working with or for Loaded Dice must:
 - Avoid any activity that could be seen as bribery or corruption.
 - Stay alert to potential risks, especially when working internationally or with third parties.
Report any concerns immediately to the Managing Director.

5. Facilitation Payments

Facilitation payments (small unofficial payments to speed up routine tasks)

are bribes and strictly prohibited.

The only exception is where refusing a payment would put someone's life or safety at risk. Any such payment must be reported to the Managing Director as soon as possible.

6. Gifts and Hospitality

Gifts and hospitality can support good business relationships but must be handled carefully.

They are acceptable only if they are:

- Reasonable, proportionate, and infrequent.
- Not intended to influence a decision or secure business unfairly.
- Recorded in the Gifts & Hospitality Register.

The following rules apply:

- Cash gifts are never allowed.
- Do not give or accept gifts or hospitality during contract tenders or negotiations.
- If refusing a gift would cause significant cultural offence, it must be reported and donated to charity.

7. Charitable Donations

- Donations may only be made to registered charities.
- All donations must be recorded and proof of receipt obtained.
- Donations must never be used to gain a business advantage.
Cash donations are not permitted.

8. Political Donations

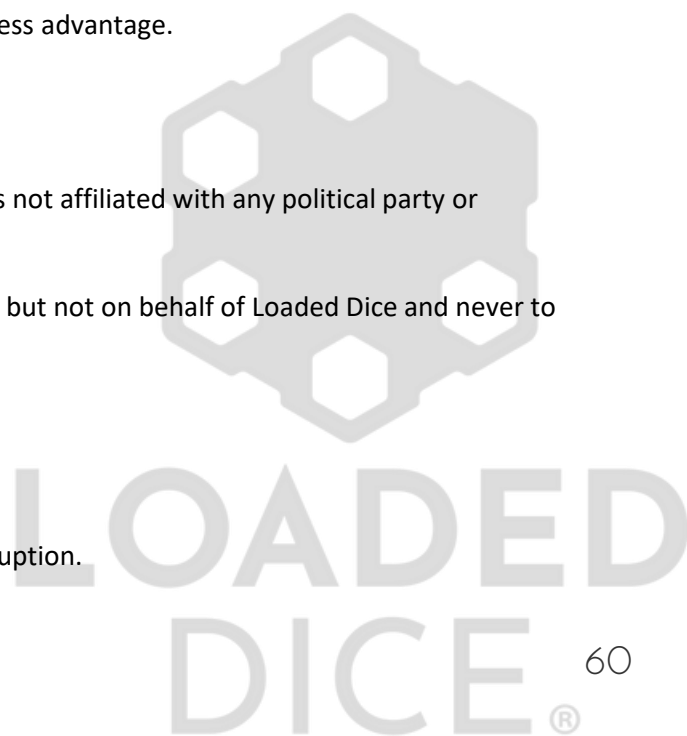
The Company does not make political donations and is not affiliated with any political party or candidate.

Employees may make personal political contributions, but not on behalf of Loaded Dice and never to secure a business advantage.

9. Risk Awareness and Due Diligence

Be especially vigilant when:

- Operating in countries with high levels of corruption.



- Being asked to use unusual payment methods (e.g., cash or intermediaries).
- Dealing with permits, licences, customs, or import/export matters. Working with new or unfamiliar third parties.

Always carry out due diligence and seek advice if unsure.

10. Reporting Concerns

If you suspect or become aware of bribery or corruption, you must report it. Concerns can be raised with:

- Managing Director or Assistant Managing Director

Reports will be treated seriously, confidentially, and without retaliation.

11. Summary – What This Means for You

- Do not give or accept bribes.
- Avoid anything that could appear improper.
- Report concerns immediately. When in doubt, ask before acting.

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt

Position: Managing Director

Date: 23/9/25

Signature: *Graham Scutt*



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Anti-Theft Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 25 Sept 2025

1. Purpose Loaded Dice is committed to protecting its people, property, assets, and reputation. This

Anti-Theft

Policy sets out the standards of behaviour expected of all employees, contractors, and visitors to ensure Loaded Dice property and customer property are safeguarded against theft, loss, or misuse.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

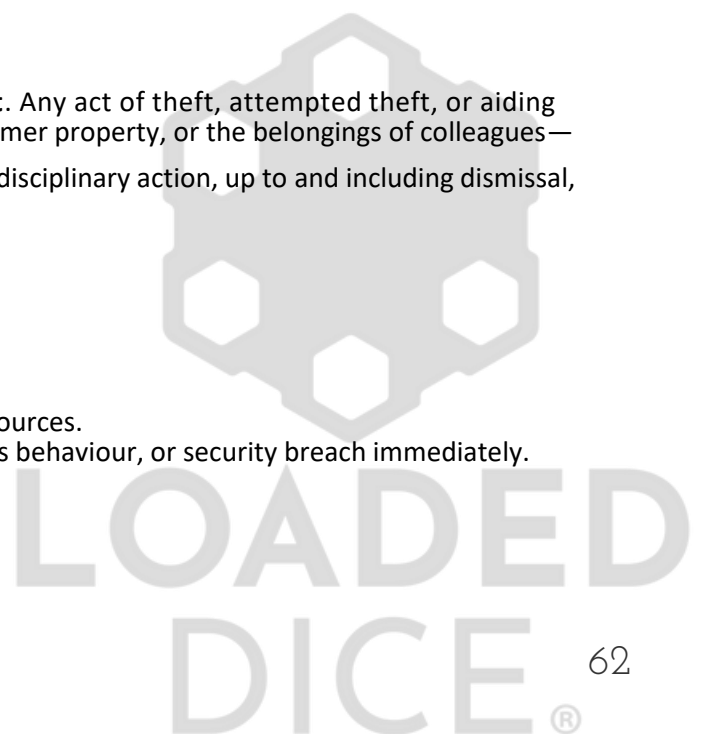
- All employees, whether permanent, temporary, or agency.
- Contractors, suppliers, and consultants working on Loaded Dice premises.
- Visitors granted access to Loaded Dice premises.

3. Policy Statement

Loaded Dice has a **zero-tolerance approach to theft**. Any act of theft, attempted theft, or aiding theft—whether involving Loaded Dice property, customer property, or the belongings of colleagues—will be treated as gross misconduct and may result in disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal, and referral to the police.

4. Responsibilities

- Employees must:
 - Safeguard Loaded Dice assets and resources.
 - Report any suspected theft, suspicious behaviour, or security breach immediately.
 - Keep personal belongings secure.
- Managers must:



- o Ensure employees are aware of this policy.
 - o Investigate reports of theft promptly and fairly.
- Loaded Dice will:
 - o Maintain security measures (e.g., CCTV, access controls, locks, alarm systems).
 - o Cooperate fully with law enforcement where theft is suspected.

5. Loaded Dice Property

- All tools, equipment, stock, materials, documents, IT hardware, and intellectual property belong to Loaded Dice and must not be removed without prior authorisation.
- Misuse, unauthorised possession, or removal of Loaded Dice property will be treated as theft.

6. Searches

Where reasonable grounds exist, Loaded Dice reserves the right to:

- Conduct searches of employee personal property (bags, lockers, vehicles on Loaded Dice premises).
- Review CCTV footage in line with UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018. Refusal to comply with a reasonable search request may itself be treated as a disciplinary matter.

7. Reporting

- Any suspected theft must be reported immediately to a line manager or the HR manager.
- Reports will be handled confidentially, and retaliation against whistleblowers will not be tolerated.

8. Disciplinary Action

- Proven theft will normally be classed as **gross misconduct**, leading to summary dismissal.
- Loaded Dice reserves the right to involve the police and pursue criminal or civil action.

9. Review of Policy

This policy will be reviewed annually to ensure it remains compliant with UK law and reflects best practice.

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt
 Position: Managing Director
 Date: 25/9/25
 Signature: *Graham Scutt*



LOADED
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Home Working Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 24 Sept 2025

1. Policy Statement Loaded Dice recognises that its people are its most valuable asset. We are committed to supporting flexible ways of working that balance business needs with employees' wellbeing. Home working is one form of flexible working. It may be arranged on a regular or occasional basis, where appropriate to the role and subject to agreement with Loaded Dice. This policy sets out the principles, processes and responsibilities for home working.

2. Aims and Benefits

This policy aims to:

- provide greater flexibility and choice in working arrangements;
- support employee wellbeing and work-life balance;
- improve recruitment and retention;
- maintain or enhance efficiency and service delivery;
- reduce environmental impact and optimise use of office space.

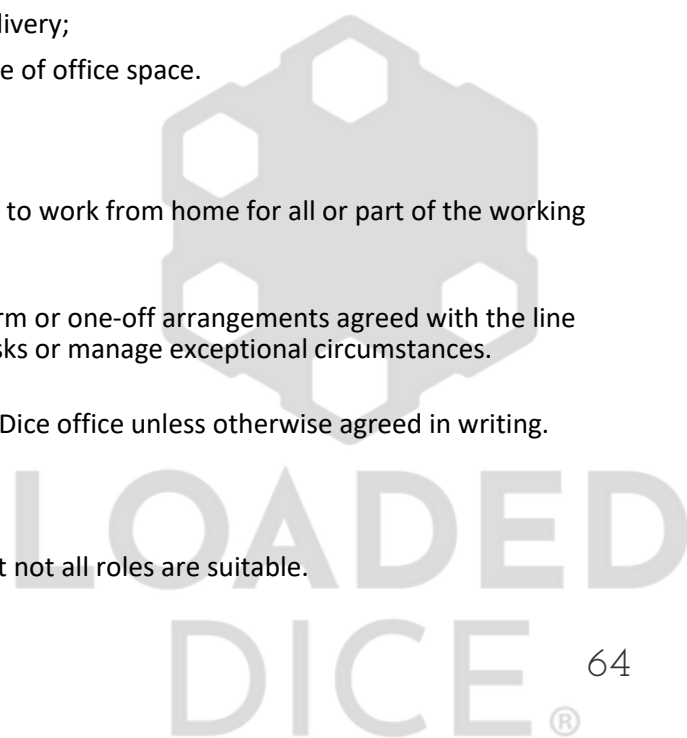
3. Definition of Home Working

- **Regular Home Working** – a formal agreement to work from home for all or part of the working week.
- **Occasional/Ad hoc Home Working** – short-term or one-off arrangements agreed with the line manager, for example to complete specific tasks or manage exceptional circumstances.

The employee's contractual base remains the Loaded Dice office unless otherwise agreed in writing.

4. Principles

- All employees may request home working, but not all roles are suitable.



- Requests will be considered fairly, consistently and in line with current flexible working legislation. Home working must support both business needs and employee needs. Employees working from home are expected to maintain regular contact with their line manager and remain available during agreed working hours. Loaded Dice treats home- and office-based staff equitably.

5. Requesting Home Working

- Requests should be made in writing to the line manager, setting out the reasons, proposed start date, and how any impact on the business can be managed.
 - Loaded Dice will meet with the employee within 28 days of receiving a request and confirm the outcome in writing.
 - Approved arrangements will be subject to a trial period before confirmation.
 - Decisions will consider role requirements, service delivery, costs, and employee circumstances.
- Employees may appeal refusals in line with the Loaded Dice Flexible Working Policy.
- All approved home working arrangements require a signed Home Working Agreement.

6. Equipment and Connectivity

- Loaded Dice will provide necessary IT equipment (e.g., laptop, headset, secure access to systems).
 - Where business needs require additional equipment, this will be agreed in advance.
- Equipment remains Loaded Dice property and must be used only for business purposes. Employees are responsible for taking reasonable care of Loaded Dice equipment and returning it when requested.
- Use of personal equipment may be permitted if it meets Loaded Dice security and health and safety standards.

7. Health, Safety and Wellbeing

- The Health and Safety at Work Act applies to all employees, regardless of location.
- Employees must ensure they have a safe and suitable home working environment, free from avoidable disruption.
- A risk assessment (self-assessment or Loaded Dice-led) must be completed before home working begins and reviewed periodically.
- Employees must follow safe working practices and report concerns to their manager. Failure to comply with health and safety requirements may result in withdrawal of home working arrangements.

8. Insurance and Financial Responsibilities

- Loaded Dice-issued equipment is covered by the Loaded Dice insurance. Employees must take reasonable precautions to protect it.
- Employees remain responsible for their own home and contents insurance and for notifying insurers, landlords or mortgage providers if required.
- Loaded Dice will not be liable for costs arising from employees' failure to secure such permissions.
- Expenses related to home working (e.g., broadband contribution) will be agreed in the Home Working Agreement and reimbursed in line with Loaded Dice policy.

9. Confidentiality, Security and Data Protection

- Employees must comply with the Loaded Dice Data Protection and IT Security policies at all

- times. Loaded Dice information must be stored securely and kept confidential. Employees
- must use Loaded Dice-approved systems (e.g., VPN, cloud storage, MFA) and must not transfer
- information via personal email or devices without authorisation. Breaches of confidentiality or
- data security will be treated as a disciplinary matter.

10. Hours of Work, Leave and Absence

- Employees and their line manager will agree working patterns in the Home Working Agreement.
- Employees must take appropriate rest breaks and comply with Working Time Regulations. Requests for annual leave and reporting of sickness absence must follow the normal Loaded Dice procedures.

11. Monitoring and Performance

- Home workers will be managed based on outcomes and performance standards, not physical presence. Regular communication (e.g., team meetings, one-to-ones) will be maintained to support collaboration and wellbeing. Loaded Dice reserves the right to review, vary or withdraw home working arrangements where they no longer meet business or performance needs.

12. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed every two years, or earlier if legislation or business needs change.

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt
 Position: Managing Director
 Date: 24/9/25
 Signature:

Graham Scutt



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Flexible Working Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 25 Sept 2025

1. Purpose Loaded Dice recognises that flexible working can benefit both employees and the business

by improving work–life balance, increasing engagement, and supporting diversity and inclusion. This policy sets out the rights of employees to request flexible working and how Loaded Dice will handle such requests in line with UK legislation.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees of Loaded Dice, regardless of role or seniority, who meet the statutory requirements to make a flexible working request.

3. Right to Request Flexible Working

3.1 From 6 April 2024, all employees have the statutory right to request flexible working from the first day of employment.

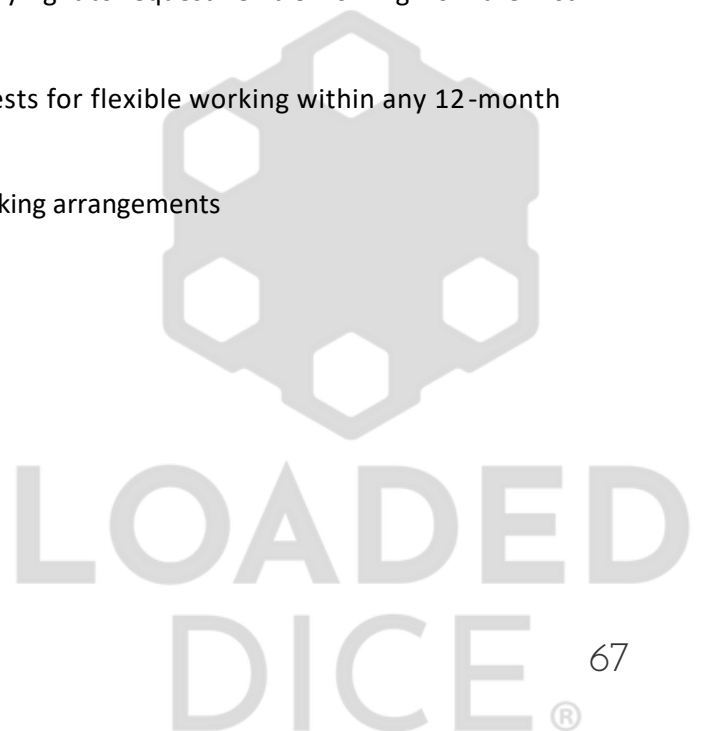
3.2 Employees may make up to two statutory requests for flexible working within any 12-month period.

4. Types of Flexible Working

Examples of flexible working arrangements

include (but are not limited to):

- Part-time working
- Job sharing
- Flexi-time
- Compressed hours
- Annualised hours
- Staggered hours
- Hybrid or remote working



5. Making a Request

5.1 Requests must be submitted in writing to the Managing Director, clearly stating:

- The change requested and proposed start date
- Whether a previous request has been made within the last 12 months
- The effect the employee thinks the change may have on the business and how this could be managed

5.2 Loaded Dice may also accept informal requests for flexible working outside of the statutory process where appropriate.

6. Consideration of Requests 6.1 Loaded Dice will deal with all requests fairly, consistently, and

promptly. A decision will normally be given within two months of receiving the request (unless extended by mutual agreement).

6.2 A meeting may be held with the employee to discuss the request in detail. Employees may be accompanied at this meeting by a colleague or trade union representative.

6.3 Requests will be assessed based on business needs, taking into account factors such as:

- The burden of additional costs
- The ability to meet customer demand
- Impact on quality, performance, or productivity
- Ability to reorganise work among staff or recruit additional employees

7. Outcome

7.1 If the request is agreed, the change will be confirmed in writing and form a permanent variation to the employee's contract, unless otherwise agreed (e.g. a trial period).

7.2 If the request is refused, Loaded Dice will provide a written explanation citing one of the statutory business grounds for refusal.

7.3 Employees may appeal a decision by submitting an appeal in writing within 14 days of the decision.

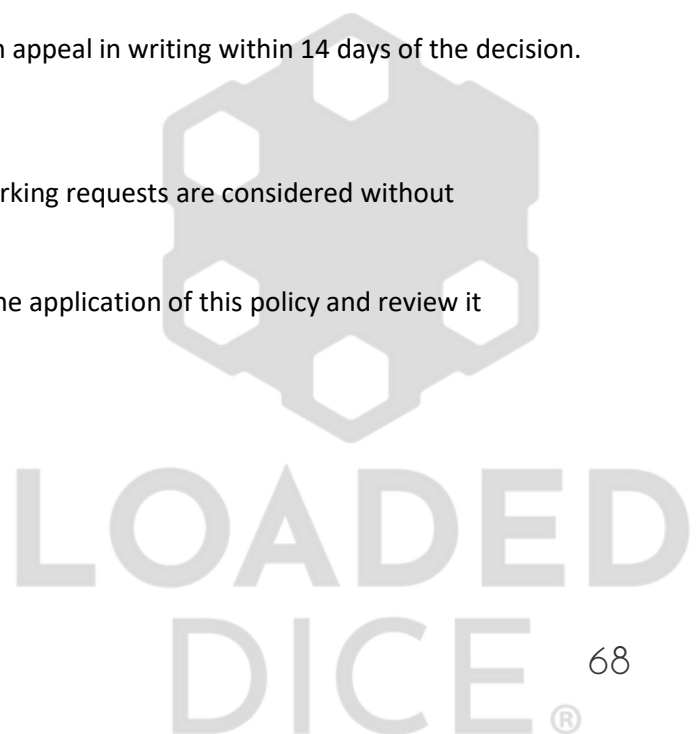
8. Equality and Diversity

Loaded Dice is committed to ensuring that flexible working requests are considered without discrimination and in line with the Equality Act 2010.

9. Monitoring and Review Loaded Dice will monitor the application of this policy and review it

regularly to ensure compliance with UK law and alignment with business needs.

This policy has been approved and authorised by:



Name: Graham Scutt
Position: Managing Director
Date: 25/9/25

Signature: *Graham Scutt*



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Maternity Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 24 Sept 2025

1. Introduction

1.1 It is the policy of Loaded Dice to ensure that, as far as possible, employees are able to balance their career and family responsibilities. Loaded Dice recognises that parenthood brings additional responsibilities and is committed to supporting employees throughout this period.

1.2 This policy sets out the statutory rights and responsibilities of employees who are pregnant or have recently given birth. Loaded Dice implements maternity rights as set out in current legislation.

1.3 The following abbreviations are used in this policy:

- **EWC** – Expected Week of Childbirth: the week, starting on a Sunday, in which a doctor or midwife expects the employee to give birth.
- **QW** – Qualifying Week: the 15th week before the EWC.

1.4 Employees and their partners may also be eligible for Shared Parental Leave (SPL), which enables parents to share leave and pay in the first year. Employees must take at least two weeks of maternity leave immediately following the birth before opting into SPL. For more details, see the Company's Shared Parental Leave Policy.

1.5 This policy applies to employees only. It does not apply to agency workers or self-employed contractors. The policy does not form part of any employee's contract of employment and may be amended by the Loaded Dice at any time.

2. Time Off for Antenatal Care

2.1 Once an employee has notified their line manager of their pregnancy, they are entitled to reasonable paid time off to attend antenatal appointments recommended by a doctor, midwife or health visitor. Antenatal care may include relaxation and parentcraft classes.

2.2 This right applies regardless of the employee's length of service.

2.3 Employees who are the father of the baby or the partner of the pregnant employee are entitled to unpaid time off to attend up to two antenatal appointments (maximum 6.5 hours each).

3. Entitlement to Maternity Leave

All employees are entitled to up to 52 weeks' maternity leave, consisting of:

- 26 weeks' Ordinary Maternity Leave (OML), and
- 26 weeks' Additional Maternity Leave (AML).

4. Notification of Pregnancy

4.1 Employees should notify their line manager of their pregnancy as soon as possible so that Loaded Dice can carry out any necessary health and safety risk assessments.

4.2 By the end of the Qualifying Week (QW), or as soon as reasonably practicable afterwards, the employee must provide the following in writing:

- confirmation of pregnancy,
- their Expected Week of Childbirth (EWC), and
- the date they intend to start maternity leave.

4.3 The employee must also provide their MAT B1 form, signed by a doctor or midwife, confirming the EWC.

5. Maternity Leave

5.1 Maternity leave can start no earlier than 11 weeks before the EWC, unless the baby is born earlier.

5.2 Leave will begin on the earliest of:

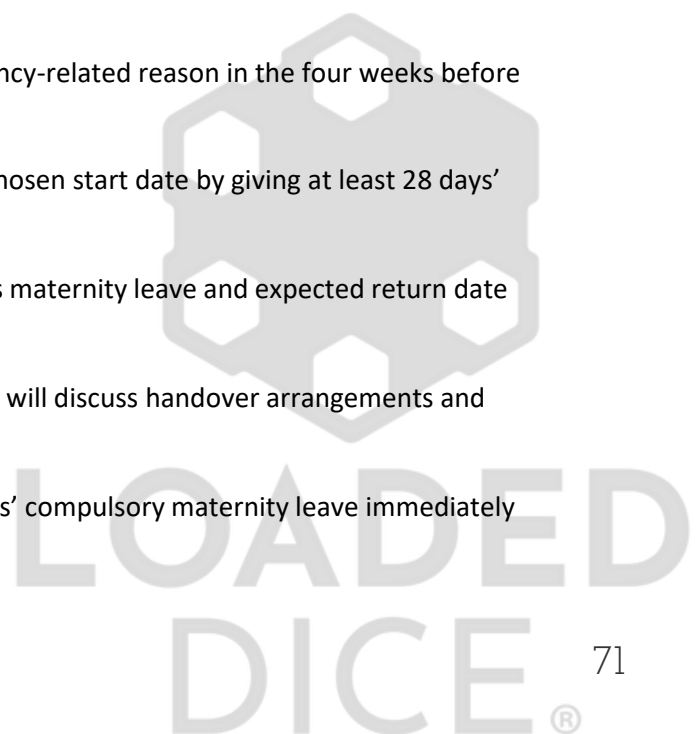
- the employee's chosen start date,
- the day after childbirth, or
- the day after absence from work for a pregnancy-related reason in the four weeks before the EWC.

5.3 Employees may bring forward or postpone their chosen start date by giving at least 28 days' written notice (or as soon as reasonably practicable).

5.4 Loaded Dice will confirm in writing the employee's maternity leave and expected return date within 28 days of receiving notification.

5.5 Shortly before maternity leave starts, Loaded Dice will discuss handover arrangements and options for staying in touch.

5.6 By law, all employees must take at least two weeks' compulsory maternity leave immediately after childbirth (four weeks for factory workers).



6. Maternity Pay

6.1 Employees with at least 26 weeks' continuous service at the end of the QW, and who meet the earnings threshold, are entitled to Statutory Maternity Pay (SMP) for up to 39 weeks.

6.2 SMP is paid as follows:

- First 6 weeks: 90% of average weekly earnings,
- Next 33 weeks: at the government-set rate (or 90% of average weekly earnings if lower).

7. Rights During Maternity Leave

7.1 During maternity leave, the employee's contract of employment remains in force, except for the right to remuneration.

7.2 Employees will:

- retain all contractual rights (e.g., notice, redundancy pay, access to grievance and disciplinary procedures, and implied obligations of trust and confidence), and
- remain bound by contractual obligations (e.g., confidentiality, good faith, and restrictions on other employment).

7.3 Statutory and contractual holiday entitlement continues to accrue during maternity leave.

7.4 The timing of holiday should be agreed before maternity leave begins. Loaded Dice may:

- require employees to take outstanding holiday before leave,
- allow it to be carried forward, or
- pay in lieu of contractual holiday entitlement above the statutory minimum.

7.5 If the employee is a member of a pension scheme, Loaded Dice will continue employer contributions during OML and any paid AML, based on normal salary. Employee contributions will be based on maternity pay unless the employee opts to maintain full contributions.

7.6 Employees may, by agreement, work up to 10 "Keeping in Touch" (KIT) days during maternity leave. KIT days are paid at the normal basic rate, inclusive of maternity pay.

7.7 Loaded Dice may make reasonable contact during maternity leave but will not require work to be undertaken.

8. Returning to Work

8.1 Employees are expected to return on their confirmed return date unless they request otherwise. Employees wishing to return earlier must give at least eight weeks' notice.

8.2 Employees returning from OML are entitled to return to their original job on the same terms and conditions.

8.3 Employees returning from AML are entitled to return to their original job, or if this is not reasonably practicable, to a suitable alternative role on no less favourable terms.

8.4 Employees wishing to change working hours or arrangements on return from maternity leave may request this under the Company's Flexible Working Policy.

8.5 Employees who decide not to return must resign in accordance with their contract of employment.

9. Shared Parental Leave

9.1 Employees may be eligible to opt into Shared Parental Leave (SPL) once they have taken at least two weeks of maternity leave.

9.2 To end maternity leave and opt into SPL, employees must give at least eight weeks' written notice. SPL allows the remaining maternity leave and pay to be shared with a partner, subject to eligibility.

10. Pregnancy Loss

10.1 In the event of a miscarriage before 24 weeks, employees will be supported through the Company's Sickness Absence Policy.

10.2 In the event of a stillbirth or neonatal loss at or after 24 weeks, employees remain entitled to the full maternity leave and pay provisions outlined in this policy.

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt

Position: Managing Director

Date: 24/9/25

Signature: *Graham Scutt*



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Paternity Leave Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 24 Sept 2025

1. Introduction Loaded Dice is committed to supporting employees in balancing their career and family responsibilities. We recognise the importance of enabling employees to support their partner following the birth of a child. This policy sets out employees' rights and responsibilities in relation to paternity leave. A separate policy applies for adoptive parents.

2. Aims of the Policy

- To provide employees with the time they need to care for their new child and support their partner.
- To comply with all statutory obligations relating to paternity leave and pay, and, where applicable, to provide enhanced benefits as outlined in section 7.

3. Antenatal Appointments

Employees are entitled to take unpaid time off to accompany a pregnant partner to up to two antenatal appointments, with a maximum of six and a half hours per appointment.

4. Paternity Leave

4.1 Eligibility

Employees are entitled to up to two consecutive weeks (or one week, if preferred) of Paternity Leave if they:

- Expect to share responsibility for the child's upbringing; and
- Are the child's biological father or the partner of the child's mother; and
- Have at least 26 weeks' continuous employment with Loaded Dice by the end of the 15th week before the expected week of childbirth; and

- Provide Loaded Dice with a completed self-certificate confirming eligibility.

4.2 Start of Leave Paternity

Leave may begin:

- On the date of the child's birth (whether earlier or later than expected); or
- On a chosen date within 56 days of the actual date of birth; or
- Within 56 days of the expected week of childbirth if the baby is born early.

Leave must be taken in a single block (one or two consecutive weeks). Only one period of Paternity Leave is available, regardless of whether more than one child is born from the same pregnancy.

4.3 Relationship with Shared Parental Leave Employees who wish to take both Paternity Leave and

Shared Parental Leave must take their Paternity Leave first.

5. In the Event of Death of the Baby

- If a stillbirth occurs after 24 weeks of pregnancy, the employee remains entitled to Paternity Leave.
 - If a stillbirth occurs before 24 weeks, the employee may take sick leave or compassionate leave, at the discretion of their line manager or HR.
- If the baby is born alive but later dies, the employee remains entitled to Paternity Leave.

6. Procedure

Employees must notify their line manager or HR by the 15th week before the expected week of childbirth, unless this is not reasonably practicable. Notification should include:

- The expected week of childbirth;
- Whether they intend to take one or two weeks; and
- The intended start date of leave.

Employees may change their intended start date provided they give at least 28 days' notice in writing. HR will confirm the agreed arrangements in writing. Employees do not need to provide notice of their return date unless they wish to return earlier than planned.

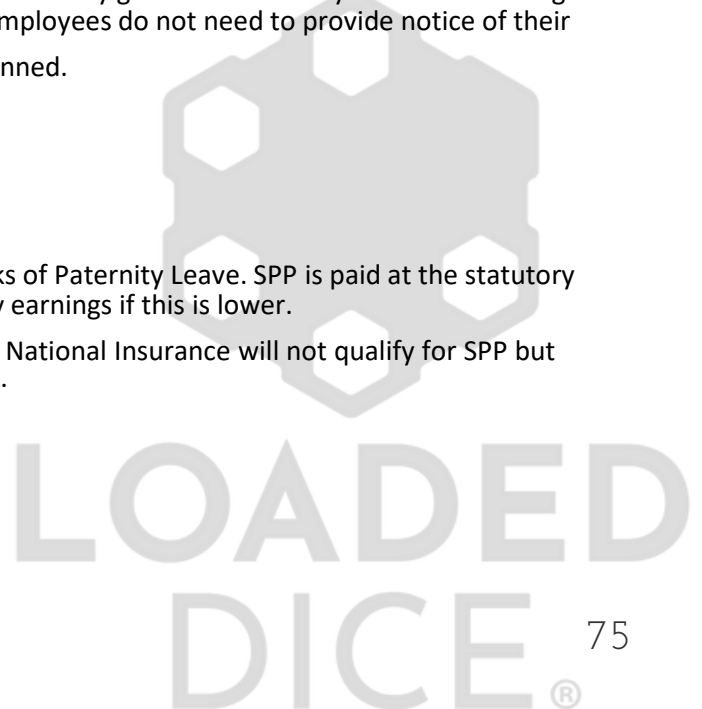
7. Paternity Pay

7.1 Statutory Paternity Pay (SPP)

Eligible employees will receive SPP for up to two weeks of Paternity Leave. SPP is paid at the statutory rate (set annually by HMRC) or 90% of average weekly earnings if this is lower.

Employees earning below the lower earnings limit for National Insurance will not qualify for SPP but may be eligible for other financial support via GOV.UK.

8. Rights During Paternity Leave



During Paternity Leave, employees:

- Remain employed under their contract, with all terms and conditions continuing, except for pay.
 - Will be kept informed of work-related news, including invitations to meetings and social events, as appropriate.
- Will return to the same job on the same terms and conditions following Paternity Leave.

9. Shared Parental Leave

Employees may take both Paternity Leave and Shared Parental Leave, provided that Paternity Leave comes first.

For full details of eligibility, notice requirements, and procedures, please refer to Loaded Dice Shared Parental Leave Policy.

10. Post-Paternity Leave

On returning from Paternity Leave, employees may request flexible working in line with Loaded Dice Flexible Working Policy.

Requests will be considered in accordance with statutory requirements and business needs. Where possible, Loaded Dice will accommodate alternative arrangements such as part-time work, job-sharing, or phased returns.

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt

Position: Managing Director

Date: 24/9/25

Signature:

Graham Scutt



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Shared Parental Leave Policy

Reviewed annually or sooner if legislation changes. Current version v1.0, issued 24 Sept 2025

1. Introduction

Shared Parental Leave (SPL) is available to eligible parents with babies due on or after 5 April 2015, or children placed for adoption on or after that date. SPL enables parents to share leave and pay in the first year after birth or adoption.

This policy applies to all employees of Loaded Dice, whether they are the mother/adopter or the partner. Each parent must liaise with their own employer to make SPL arrangements.

Employees should contact the HR Manager for guidance before submitting a request, as SPL provisions are complex.

2. Aims of the Policy

2.1 To provide eligible employees with flexibility in caring for their child in the first year.

2.2 To ensure the Company complies with its legal obligations in respect of SPL.

3. Eligibility and Provision

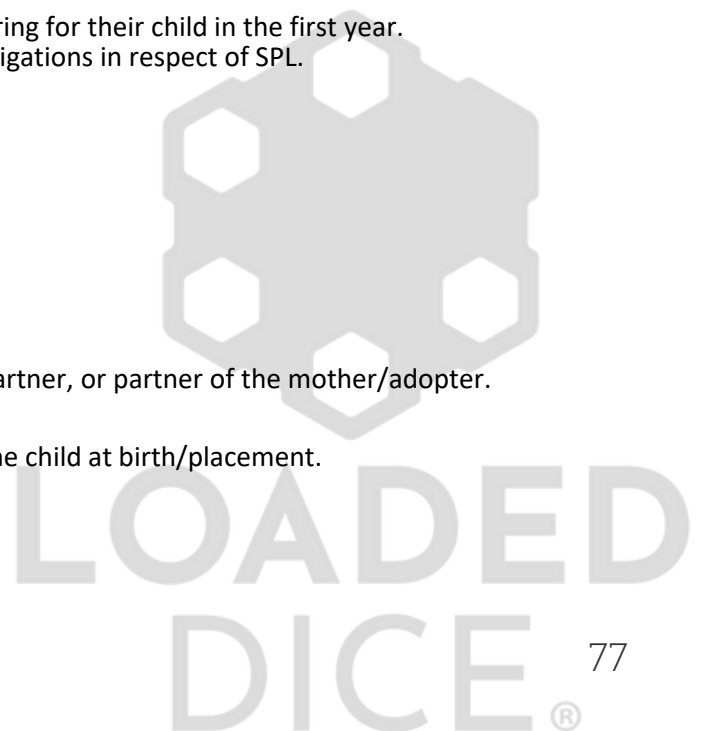
3.1 Who can take SPL

SPL can be used only by:

- the mother/adopter, and
- either the child's father, or the spouse, civil partner, or partner of the mother/adopter.

Both parents must share the main responsibility for the child at birth/placement.

3.2 Employee criteria



The employee must:

- have 26 weeks' continuous service by the 15th week before the expected due date/matching date;
- still be employed at the start of each SPL period;
- be entitled (or linked to a partner entitled) to maternity/adoption leave or pay;
- have complied with maternity/adoption curtailment and SPL notice requirements; and have a partner who meets the statutory "employment and earnings test."

4. SPL Entitlement

4.1 Eligible employees may share up to 50 weeks' leave, depending on the maternity/adoption leave curtailed.

4.2 SPL must be taken in full weeks, in either:

- a continuous block (which Loaded Dice must accept if eligibility and notice rules are met); or
- discontinuous blocks (subject to Loaded Dice agreement).

4.3 Employees may submit up to three leave notifications. If a discontinuous pattern is refused, the employee may withdraw the request within 15 days or convert it to a continuous block.

4.4 SPL must end within one year of birth/placement. Unused entitlement is lost.

5. Notice Requirements 5.1 Employees must give written notice to the HR Manager at least eight

weeks before the intended start of SPL.

5.2 Notice must include:

- the employee's name;
- the other parent's name;
- details of maternity/adoption leave or pay taken;
- the expected week of childbirth/matching date and actual date of birth/placement; the total SPL available and the intended division;
- a non-binding indication of the employee's proposed leave dates.

5.3 Employees must also provide a signed declaration confirming eligibility and accuracy of information, and (if not the mother/adopter) their parental relationship.

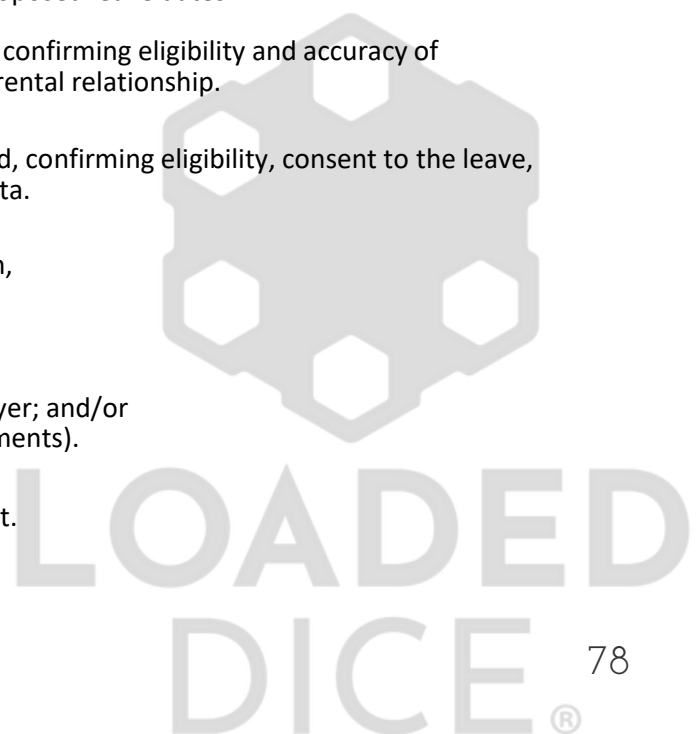
5.4 A signed partner declaration must also be provided, confirming eligibility, consent to the leave, and consent to Loaded Dice processing of personal data.

6. Evidence of Eligibility Within 14 days of notification,

Loaded Dice may request:

- the name and address of the partner's employer; and/or
- the child's birth certificate (or adoption documents).

Employees must provide this within 14 days of request.



7. Booking SPL

7.1 Notice of entitlement should usually be accompanied by a leave booking request.

7.2 Employees may submit up to three requests, each specifying continuous or discontinuous leave.

7.3 Loaded Dice will confirm acceptance or decision within 14 days of receipt. Discontinuous requests will be considered on a case-by-case basis, balancing employee needs and business impact.

8. Shared Parental Pay (ShPP)

8.1 Statutory entitlement

Eligible employees may share up to 37 weeks of statutory ShPP, depending on maternity/adoption pay already taken. ShPP is paid at the statutory rate set by the Government, or 90% of average weekly earnings if lower.

8.2 Eligibility for ShPP

The employee must:

- meet SPL eligibility;
- have average weekly earnings above the lower NI threshold;
- remain employed until the start of ShPP; and
give eight weeks' written notice to [HR Manager].

Partner declarations must confirm consent to ShPP being claimed and, where applicable, that maternity/adoption pay has been curtailed.

9. Terms and Conditions During SPL

All contractual terms, except salary, continue during SPL. Annual leave and pension contributions accrue in line with legislation and Company policy.

10. SPLIT Days Employees may work or attend training for up to 20 "Shared Parental Leave in Touch" (SPLIT) days without ending SPL or affecting ShPP. Payment arrangements for SPLIT days will be agreed in advance with the HR Manager.

11. Return to Work

11.1 Employees are expected to return on the next working day after the agreed end of SPL unless they notify Loaded Dice otherwise.

11.2 Where the total leave taken (including maternity, paternity, adoption, and SPL) is 26 weeks or less, the employee has the right to return to the same job.

11.3 If the total leave exceeds 26 weeks, or includes additional maternity or parental leave, the employee will normally return to the same job. If this is not reasonably practicable, they will return to a suitable alternative role on terms no less favourable.

This policy has been approved and authorised by:

Name: Graham Scutt
Position: Managing Director
Date: 24/9/25

Signature: *Graham Scutt*



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Employee Policy Acknowledgment Form

Employee Name: _____: Date: _____

I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understand the Loaded Dice Employee Policies and Procedures handbook.

I understand that it is my responsibility to comply with the policies, rules, and guidelines outlined in the handbook, as well as any revisions or updates that may be issued in the future.

I further acknowledge and agree that:

1. The policies described in the handbook are not intended to create, nor should they be construed as creating, a contract of employment.
2. My employment with Loaded Dice is at-will unless otherwise defined by applicable law or a written agreement signed by both Loaded Dice and myself. This means either I or Loaded Dice may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause or notice.
3. If I have questions about any policy, I will seek clarification from my supervisor or the Human Resources manager.

Employee Signature: _____

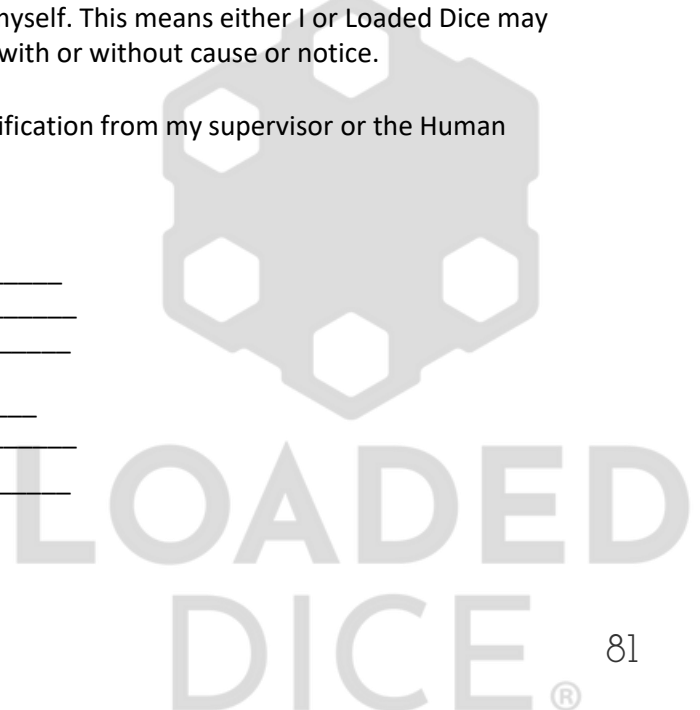
Printed Name: _____

Date: _____

Manager Signature: _____

Printed Name: _____

Date: _____



COMPANY CONTACT



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